

CM OPENS SKILL, HEALTH CENTRES IN MOTI NAGAR

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OPPN RAISES QUESTIONS OVER NCERT PANEL'S COMPOSITION

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YAMI GAUTAM DHAR TO STAR IN 'NAYI NAVELLI'

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JANTAR MANTAR PROTESTS

SC forms 5-member panel, headed by its ex-judge, to probe police excesses

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, August 20

The Supreme Court has constituted a five-member high-powered expert committee (HPEC), headed by former Supreme Court judge Justice R Subhash Reddy, to examine allegations of police excesses during student protests against paper leaks.

The other members of the committee are Justice Ravi Shankar Jha, former Chief Justice of the Punjab and Haryana High Court; Justice Shalinder Kaur, former judge of the Delhi High Court; Rishi Kumar Shukla, former Director of the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI); and Dr LR Bishnoi, retired Director General of Police, Meghalaya.

"Given our anxious and holistic consideration to the entirety of the material placed before us, along with the multitude of recommendations



CLOSER LOOK

» The committee includes former SC judge Justice R Subhash Reddy, former Chief Justice of the Punjab and Haryana HC Justice Ravi Shankar Jha, former Delhi HC judge Justice Shalinder Kaur, former CBI director Rishi Kumar Shukla and retired Meghalaya DGP Dr LR Bishnoi

» HPEC will examine alleged excessive force, including police deployment of pellet guns

» Committee will also examine alleged violence by protesters against police and security personnel

» Targeted violence, harassment and molestation allegations involving female protesters get priority

A three-judge bench headed by Chief Justice Surya Kant and comprising Justices Joymala Bagchi and V Mohana passed the order on a batch of petitions challenging alleged police excesses against Cockroach Janata Party (CJP) protesters at Jantar Mantar in the heart of the national Capital on July 20.

The apex court also said that the HPEC has been constituted bearing in mind a wide variety of considerations, including the individual expertise and experience of each of its members, as well as the diversity of the Committee, among other factors.

"We are confident that the recommendations of the HPEC will be of invaluable assistance to this Court, and the Committee will be able to undertake a comprehensive assessment of all such issues as merit," it added.

The committee has been asked to examine **CONTINUED ON P4**

Centre allows 10 lakh tonnes sugar imports to ease price pressure

Caps sugar stock for bulk consumers

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, August 20

The government on Thursday allowed duty-free imports of 10 lakh tonnes of raw sugar under the Tariff Rate Quota (TRQ) system until October 31, 2026, as domestic prices of the sweetener continued to rise.

India, the world's biggest sugar consumer, is importing sugar for the first time in nearly a decade as it seeks to bridge the supply gap before demand accelerates during the festival season. The Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT), in a notification, said the import policy had been amended to permit 10 lakh MT of raw sugar imports without duty under the TRQ.

The government has also introduced limits on the stocks that can be held by large institutional buyers. Food Minister Pralhad



HIGHLIGHTS

» Move aims to boost domestic availability and contain rising sugar prices

» Sugar prices have surged amid concerns over lower opening stocks

» India, the world's biggest sugar consumer, is importing sugar for the first time in nearly a decade

Joshi said bulk consumers using more than 10 tonnes of sugar a month would not be permitted **CONTINUED ON P4**

Jharkhand High Court stays cancellation of 11th, 13th JPSC appointments

MPOST BUREAU

Ranchi, August 20

The Jharkhand High Court on Thursday stayed the operation of state government notifications cancelling appointments made through the 11th and 13th Jharkhand Public Service Commission (JPSC) examinations. It also stayed the order cancelling the appointments of food-safety officers.

The order came while Justice Deepak Roshan was hearing a batch of petitions challenging the government decisions. The court directed the state government to file its response by September 15, when the matter will next be heard.

With the interim order, candidates selected through the 11th and 13th JPSC examinations, along with other employees affected by the cancellation notifications, will continue in their respective posts for now.

The court, however, made clear that the relief would not protect anyone found to have secured an appointment through foul play. If the ongoing investigation establishes wrongdoing in a candidate's appointment, the person will face the consequences and lose the service. The final status of the appointments will be **CONTINUED ON P4**

Briefs

Bank employee kills wife, sister, shoots self

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: An SBI field officer allegedly shot dead his wife, a relationship manager with ICICI Bank, and his sister before shooting himself at his rented house in Lucknow's Gomti Nagar area on Thursday. The motive behind the killings was not immediately clear, though police **CONTINUED ON P4**

6-yr-old collapses, dies after teacher scolds, slaps him

VISAKHAPATNAM:

A six-year-old LKG student died under mysterious circumstances at a private school in Andhra Pradesh after his family alleged that a teacher slapped and assaulted him for not completing his homework.

According to the family, the child became frightened and started crying and coughing before collapsing at the school. **CONTINUED ON P4**

HC bench for Ladakh approved

NEW DELHI: The Union Cabinet has approved a bench of the Jammu and Kashmir High Court in Ladakh to improve access to justice in the Union Territory, Home Minister Amit Shah said on Thursday.

Shah said the move would reduce the time needed for residents of remote and difficult-to-reach areas to access legal services. **CONTINUED ON P4**

SC: 1978 'industry' definition not valid under 2020 code

New labour code not bound by 1978 interpretation

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, August 20

The Supreme Court on Thursday ruled that its broad, worker-friendly interpretation of the term "industry" in a landmark 1978 judgment will not govern fresh cases under the Industrial Relations Code, 2020. However, the court said the interpretation will continue to apply to proceedings under the now-repealed Industrial Disputes Act, 1947.

A nine-judge Constitution bench headed by Chief Justice Surya Kant delivered the verdict by a 6:3 majority. The bench held that the reference seeking reconsideration of the 1978 judgment by a seven-judge bench in the Bangalore Water Supply and Sewerage Board case was validly made.

The Chief Justice authored the majority judgment for himself and Justices Satish Chandra Sharma, Alok Aradhe and Vipul M Pancholi. Justices P S Narasimha and Joymalya

THE COURT CLARIFIED THAT THE "TRIPLE TEST" LAID DOWN BY JUSTICE V R KRISHNA IYER IN THE 1978 JUDGMENT REMAINS VALID

Bagchi agreed with the CJI on several issues. Justices B V Nagarathna, Dipankar Datta and Ujjal Bhuyan dissented on whether the reference to the nine-judge bench was maintainable.

The court clarified that the "triple test" laid down by Justice V R Krishna Iyer in the 1978 judgment remains valid. The test broadly considers whether a systematic activity involving cooperation between employers and employees for producing or distributing goods and services amounts to an "industry".

The majority said the test has been refined through Thursday's judgment, but the revised interpretation cannot be applied to **CONTINUED ON P4**

BILATERAL ENGAGEMENT



Prime Minister Narendra Modi during a meeting with the Defence Minister of Japan, Shinjiro Koizumi, in New Delhi

REPORT ON P4

Sajjan Kumar, serving life terms in 1984 riots cases, dies at 80

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, August 20

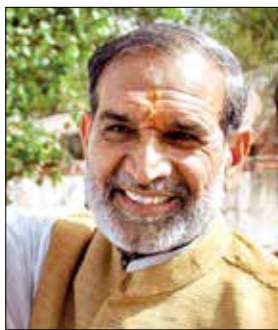
Former Congress MP Sajjan Kumar, who was serving two life sentences for cases linked to the 1984 anti-Sikh riots, died at Safdarjung Hospital in Delhi on Thursday. He was 80.

Kumar was brought from Tihar jail to the hospital around 11 am after developing an altered sensorium. According to a hospital statement, he

was admitted immediately, and doctors began resuscitation. "Despite providing all necessary medical and life-support measures, he could not be saved and passed away at 12:30 pm," the hospital said.

The hospital said Kumar had high blood pressure and Parkinson's disease and had been admitted to the hospital several times in the past.

His death came on a day when the Supreme Court



was scheduled to hear his plea seeking three weeks of parole on medical grounds

South CMs meet Shah over Cauvery, NEET, delimitation

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Chennai, August 20

Delimitation, protection of southern states' parliamentary representation, NEET, Cauvery River water sharing and greater fiscal autonomy were among the key issues raised at the Southern Zonal Council meeting chaired by Union Home Minister Amit Shah in Mahabalipuram, Tamil Nadu, on Thursday.

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister Joseph Vijay sought safeguards against any reduction in the South's parliamentary voice after delimitation. He said the



Amit Shah

1971 Census-based freeze on Lok Sabha seat allocation was nearing its end and argued that states that achieved population stabilisation should not be penalised. Karnataka Chief Minister DK Shivakumar sought a resolution to retain the 543-seat Lok

Sabha strength for 25 years and restore Karnataka's tax share from 3.6 per cent to 4.7 per cent. Vijay also sought exemption from NEET, proposing MBBS, BDS and AYUSH admissions under the state quota based on Class 12 marks.

Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu proposed diverting over 500 TMC through the Godavari-Cauvery link. Kerala offered water from a proposed new Mullaperiyar dam if Tamil Nadu agreed to the project. Telangana also backed greater southern cooperation on shared priorities. **SEE P5**

YAMUNA REVIVAL, 40 LAKH HOMES, 695-KM METRO

Delhi Master Plan 2047 maps two-decade growth strategy

AIMAN FATIMA, SHIVANGI SHUKLA

New Delhi, August 20

The Centre on Thursday unveiled the Delhi Master Plan 2047 (MPD-2047), a long-term planning framework for the national capital that proposes large-scale housing, redevelopment, transport expansion, environmental restoration and regulatory reforms to guide Delhi's growth over the next two decades. The plan was launched by Union Housing and Urban Affairs Minister Manohar Lal in the presence of Lieutenant



Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu and Chief Minister Rekha Gupta.

The Master Plan projects the development of

around 40 lakh new homes through multiple interventions, including around 18 lakh affordable houses in Transit-Oriented Develop-

ment (TOD) zones, redevelopment of existing residential colonies, rehabilitation of JJ clusters, rental housing, workers'

housing and land pooling. Redevelopment norms for group housing, DDA and government housing colonies have **CONTINUED ON P4**

ANCHOR TAKEAWAYS

» About 18 lakh affordable homes are proposed in TOD zones

» Easier norms could facilitate around seven lakh additional dwelling units

» Land pooling aims to create around 12 lakh homes with 600-km roads

» Metro network is proposed to expand from 416 km to 695 km

» Around 1,700 hectares of Yamuna floodplain will undergo ecological restoration

» Master Plan seeks conservation of around 1,500 heritage assets

» Dwarka is proposed as an investment hub for IT and startups

» Land-use categories will fall from 133 to 45 through regulatory reforms

» ABOUT 45 LAKH RESIDENTS COULD GAIN PROPERTY SECURITY IN 1,511 COLONIES

UGC equity rules 2026 under reconsideration: Centre to SC

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, August 20

The Centre on Thursday told the Supreme Court that the University Grants Commission's (UGC) 2026 regulations aimed at preventing caste-based discrimination in higher education institutions are under reconsideration.

"This is the UGC regulation matter. It is under reconsideration," Solicitor General Tushar Mehta told a bench headed by Chief Justice Surya Kant and comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana.

The bench directed the UGC to file a comprehensive counter-affidavit within four weeks. The petitioners may submit their rejoinders within two weeks after the affidavit is filed.

The court was hearing a batch of petitions challenging the validity of the University Grants Commission (Promotion of Equity in Higher Education Institutions) Regulations, 2026.

On January 29, the Supreme Court had ordered that the 2026 regulations be kept in abeyance, describing **CONTINUED ON P4**

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WHOLESALE SHIFTS, TECH HUBS, HOUSING, METRO AND CIVIC INFRASTRUCTURE GET A NEW BLUEPRINT

MPD-2047: A blueprint for change

AIMAN FATIMA
New Delhi, August 20

The Master Plan for Delhi-2047 (MPD-2047) unveiled on Thursday proposes changes across the Capital's commercial areas, transport network, housing, digital infrastructure, environment and civic services, with measures ranging from relocating wholesale and warehousing activities from the Walled City to creating new technology hubs and expanding the Metro network.

Walled City, markets and heritage

The plan proposes shifting wholesale and warehousing activities from the Walled City, including Chandni Chowk and Sadar Bazaar, to compatible locations outside the city centre to reduce freight congestion. Warehouses of one hectare or more with access to roads of at least 30 metres may also undertake retail activity. Karol Bagh will get

an improvement plan with removal of encroachments and unauthorised construction. Connaught Place's existing plot layout will be retained without subdivision, while Mandi House's cultural character will be preserved.

Lutyens' Bungalow Zone and Civil Lines Bungalow Area will retain their low-rise character, large plots, avenues and landscaping, with no high-intensity or Metro-corridor development. The Walled City will be promoted as a cultural and "Active Travel Area", with pedestrianisation, cycling and cycle-sharing, heritage walks, cafés, museums, libraries, craft centres, guest houses and bed-and-breakfast facilities.

Five archaeological parks, Mehrauli, Tughlaqabad, Sultan Garhi, Indraprastha and Northern Ridge, will receive conservation plans. Heritage buildings may be adaptively reused, subject to preservation

of their character, with a 50-FAR TDR incentive, Heritage Cells and a Heritage Fund. Cultural hubs, night walks, festivals and night markets are also proposed.

Metro-led growth and land pooling

MPD-2047 proposes expanding Delhi's existing 416-km Metro network by around 279 km, taking it to nearly 695 km. The proposed RRTS network is expected to reach around 383 km, linking Delhi with Ghaziabad, Meerut, Panipat, Karnal and Alwar.

Around 200 sq km has been identified for TOD, with higher-density mixed-use development permitted within 500 metres on either side of Metro corridors and within a 500-metre radius of major regional and inter-state transit stations. A further 20 sq km along the executed UER-II has been identified as a High Density Corridor for residential, logistics, warehousing

and commercial activities.

Land pooling will cover nearly 200 sq km, potentially generating 12 lakh homes and a 600-km road network. DDA will follow an infrastructure-first approach by developing roads of 30 metres and above. Town Planning Schemes will be used for areas of at least 20 hectares, while a High Density Corridor along UER-II will allow FAR up to 400 along a 250-metre-wide corridor. Sector 8B, Zone P-II, covering Gadi Khasro and Ibrahimpur, has been identified as the first notified sector ready for implementation.

Digital infrastructure and AI

The plan envisages a digital infrastructure network comprising 5G, optical fibre, smart poles and unified command-and-control centres. AI will be used for traffic forecasting, dynamic public transport fleet and parking management, while real-time commuter

information and app-based integration will connect different modes of transport.

Smart poles in public areas may carry CCTV cameras, sensors and public information systems. A proposed Technology and Innovation Zone will bring together semiconductor development, drone technology, AI, startups, digital governance and advanced computing.

The proposed initiatives require an indicative 41-62 acres: 25-30 acres for a semiconductor and electronics ecosystem, 10-20 acres for drone innovation and testing, 5-10 acres for the DISHA Innovation Hub and 1-2 acres for a State Data Centre and AI infrastructure. Data centres will also be permitted in industrial areas, while optical-fibre ducts may be provided along roads with 12-metre ROW and above. Cybersecurity measures and global wireless and broadband stan-

dards are proposed.

Yamuna restoration and green network

The plan proposes intercepting and treating all 22 drains flowing into the Yamuna through sewage treatment, constructed wetlands and bio-remediation. Untreated sewage, wastewater, industrial effluents and solid waste discharge into the river and other water bodies will be prohibited.

Along the 22-km Wazirabad-Okhla stretch, 13 major restoration projects covering around 1,700 hectares will focus on wetlands, natural depressions, floodplain ecosystems and biodiversity. Existing wetlands will be desilted and new storage basins created. Riverine forests and grasslands, green buffers and groundwater-recharge measures are proposed.

A 200-km Ridge-Yamuna Park Connector cycling network, including 52 km along the floodplain, is proposed.

A 75-100 metre public greenway may be developed along embankments with walking, cycling and passive recreation facilities. The active floodplain will remain a "no-construction zone", except for permitted recreational uses. Unauthorised structures, including religious structures, will be removed on priority, while essential utilities will require approval.

Pandemic and disaster preparedness

The plan seeks to make Delhi better prepared for pandemics by encouraging mixed land uses and vertical mixing, so homes, workplaces and essential services remain closer together. It proposes decentralised offices, co-working spaces, shared workspaces in slum rehabilitation projects and support for home-based work.

Large green spaces, open areas and public plazas will be incorporated into new developments

and regeneration projects to provide space during health emergencies. Affordable rental and ownership housing, worker housing and hostels are proposed to expand accommodation options for migrants.

For fires and earthquakes, dedicated evacuation areas and refuge spaces will be identified in neighbourhoods, particularly densely populated ones. Parks, multipurpose grounds and open spaces may serve as evacuation areas, while RWAs and local bodies may identify refuge spaces during infectious disease outbreaks. Helipads may be provided on suitable high-rise buildings and hospitals for emergency air evacuation.

Crematoriums and animal last rites

The plan proposes time-bound modernisation of existing crematoriums and encourages electric and gas-fired cremation and eco-friendly wood substitutes.

Briefs

L-G Sandhu reviews BRICS Summit prep

NEW DELHI: Delhi Lt Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu has directed stakeholder agencies to ensure smooth traffic and security management, robust civic upkeep, and emergency medical readiness across key venues and movement corridors for the upcoming BRICS Summit 2026. In a post on X on Thursday, Sandhu said that Delhi is fully geared up to extend an orderly, secure and warm welcome to all visiting delegates of the Summit to be held in September. The L-G reviewed preparation for the Summit in a meeting with senior officers and directed all stakeholder departments and agencies to ensure smooth traffic and security management, robust civic upkeep, and emergency medical readiness across key venues and movement corridors.

Khirwar takes stock of WTPs

NEW DELHI: Delhi Municipal Corporation Commissioner Sanjeev Khirwar on Thursday inspected under-construction waste treatment plants at Narela-Bawana, Singhola and Bhalswa. He reviewed construction progress and directed agencies to complete the projects within the stipulated timelines. He also inspected a 3,000-tonne-per-day waste-to-energy plant and ongoing biomin-ing work at Bhalswa landfill.

Tiranga art show concludes

NEW DELHI: The New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) on Thursday concluded its 10-day 'Har Ghar Tiranga 2026' art exhibition at the Janpath Subway Art Gallery, showcasing around 80 paintings and 15 sculptures. NDMC Chairman Manoj Kumar Dwivedi felicitated participating artists.

Delhi launches major MSME capacity drive

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 20

The Delhi government on Thursday launched a Mega Capacity Building Programme for micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs) under the Centre's Raising and Accelerating MSME Performance (RAMP) scheme, with over 30,000 enterprises expected to benefit through training, digital onboarding and easier access to finance.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, who inaugurated the programme organised by the Delhi State Industrial and Infrastructure Development Corporation (DSIIDC) at Anuvrat Bhawan, said the



Centre had approved Rs 49.74 crore for Delhi under the RAMP scheme. She said more than 30,000 MSMEs would receive training by January 2027, while over 10,000 businesses would

be onboarded onto digital platforms such as GeM and ONDC to improve market access. Calling MSMEs the backbone of Delhi's economy, Gupta said the government's focus was

on strengthening four pillars, finance, training, technology and markets. She also said better coordination between the Centre and the Delhi government was benefiting traders and entrepreneurs. According to the Chief Minister, Delhi has over 2.48 lakh startups and 125 unicorns.

Highlighting the Delhi Credit Guarantee Scheme (DKGS/DCGS), Gupta said eligible micro and small enterprises could avail collateral-free loans of up to Rs 10 crore, backed by a 95 per cent government credit guarantee. Since February 1, 2026, 10,505 guarantees worth Rs 4,806 crore have been approved.

Industries Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa said tenders worth around Rs 500 crore had been issued for industrial infrastructure works, while projects worth nearly Rs 700 crore were in the pipeline. He said the government was developing an AI-enabled single-window MSME portal, working on a policy to grant freehold rights to industrial properties, promoting women's entrepreneurship, and planning exhibition and business centres in Bawana and Narela. He added that stronger effluent treatment standards were also being planned to encourage water reuse and protect the Yamuna.



CM opens skill, health centres in Moti Nagar

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 20

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Thursday inaugurated a Jan Kaushal Kendra and a Swayam Swasthya Kendra in Moti Nagar, saying the twin initiatives aim to improve access to future-oriented skill training and neighbourhood healthcare. The centres have been set up by the Madan Lal Khurana Foundation. Moti Nagar MLA Harish Khurana, Umang Bajaj and other dignitaries were present at the event.

Addressing the gathering, Gupta said rapid advances in Artificial Intelligence and digital technologies have created new opportunities in employment and entrepreneurship, making industry-oriented skill development

essential alongside formal education.

She said the Jan Kaushal Kendra would provide AI training to young people while also being open to senior citizens interested in learning new technologies. "The Jan Kaushal Kendra... is an important building block in laying a strong foundation for a much larger goal," she said.

Referring to Prime Minister Narendra Modi's Independence Day address, Gupta said the Centre has set a target of equipping one crore youth with AI skills, adding that work towards this objective has begun in Delhi. The Chief Minister also inaugurated the Swayam Swasthya Kendra, describing local access to healthcare as equally important as education and skill development.

Rain cools Delhi little Cong councillor attacked, chair thrown in MCD chairman's office

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 20

Rain lashed parts of Delhi in the early morning hours on Thursday, with several weather stations recording maximum temperatures above normal despite the showers, the India Meteorological Department said.

Palam recorded the highest 24-hour rainfall at 28.4 mm, followed by Safdarjung at 8.1 mm, Ayanagar at 4.7 mm, Lodi Road at 2.4 mm and Ridge at 0.4

mm. Safdarjung recorded a maximum temperature of 35.8 degrees Celsius, 1.6 degrees above normal. Lodi Road recorded 35.6 degrees Celsius, 2.6 degrees above normal, while Ridge and Ayanagar recorded 35.3 degrees Celsius and 35 degrees Celsius, 1.4 and 0.9 degrees above normal, respectively. Palam recorded 34.2 degrees Celsius, 0.3 degrees below normal. The weather office forecasts a generally cloudy sky with light rain on Friday.

Cong councillor attacked, chair thrown in MCD chairman's office

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, August 20

A Congress councillor allegedly ran into the office of an MCD zone chairman in northeast Delhi after being attacked by a group of people, following which a scuffle broke out inside the office, causing damage to some property, officials said on Thursday. The incident took place at around 3.30

pm on Wednesday at the office of zone Chairman and Bjp leader Pankaj Luthra, who said the councillor had rushed inside while being pursued by some people.

"Two people got into a scuffle. One of them, who was a Congress councillor, rushed towards our room. We intervened and broke up the scuffle," Luthra said.

He said no Bjp councillor or party member was

involved in the incident.

A purported video of the incident shows a chair being thrown at a person while two policemen appear to be trying to protect him. The video also shows damage to property inside the chairman's office as numerous people gather inside Luthra's room. The councillor involved in the incident was identified as Congress's Hazi Zarif.

L-G reviews women & sr citizens' safety measures with Delhi Police

Zero tolerance for crimes against vulnerable groups: L-G

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 20

Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Thursday reviewed specialised policing initiatives for women and senior citizens in the national capital and directed the police to strengthen emergency response and outreach for vulnerable groups.

Sandhu held a review meeting with Delhi Police Commissioner Anurag Kumar and took stock of measures aimed at ensuring the safety and well-being of women, children and elderly residents.

During the meeting, the L-G reviewed the functioning and outreach of the Delhi Police's Senior Citizen Mobile Application and stressed the need for prompt grievance redressal, emergency assistance and



regular interaction between beat-level police personnel and elderly residents.

He directed that the number of senior citizens registered with the police be reassessed and the outreach of the mobile application widened to cover more elderly residents across the city. The L-G also reviewed the functioning and deployment of specialised 'Shishtachar Squads', which work to curb eve-teasing and street harassment, particularly around educational institutions,

SAFETY FIRST

- » He directed that the number of senior citizens registered with the police be reassessed and the outreach of the mobile application widened to cover more elderly residents across the city
- » The L-G also reviewed the functioning and deployment of specialised 'Shishtachar Squads', which work to curb eve-teasing and street harassment

transit hubs and crowded marketplaces. He stressed heightened vigilance and proactive patrolling by such teams and called for zero tolerance towards offenders to ensure a safe environment for women and girl students.

The meeting also reviewed the deployment of police personnel and security staff in Pink Buses to enhance the safety of women commuters. Sandhu stressed the importance of a visible presence of trained personnel and

quick emergency response mechanisms in public transport. The L-G called for foolproof security measures, institutional empathy and sustained vigilance to ensure that women, children and senior citizens can move freely and safely in the city.

He reiterated that there should be zero tolerance towards crimes targeting vulnerable sections and directed the Delhi Police to maintain a proactive approach towards their safety and security.

Post-I-Day sweep at Red Fort

ANAMTA FATIMA
New Delhi, August 20

The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) has intensified sanitation measures around the Red Fort following the Independence Day celebrations as part of its 'Delhi Ko Kude Se Azaadi' campaign.

The Old Delhi Zone (ODZ) conducted a special post-event cleanliness drive at the Red Fort complex and adjoining areas on Thursday. The exercise focused on clearing waste generated during the celebrations, cleaning roads and surrounding areas, and ensuring the upkeep of public spaces.

The drive was conducted in the presence of Zonal Chairperson Usha Sharma and Area Councillor Suman Gupta. Deputy Commissioner Kanika was also present during the sanitation operation.

Continuous monitoring

According to the civic body, sanitation teams have



been deployed to maintain cleanliness at the event venue and its surrounding areas. Officials said the teams would continue to monitor the area and undertake cleaning operations whenever required.

The special drive comes after the conclusion of the Independence Day celebrations at the historic monument, which attracts large numbers of visitors and participants during the national event. The civic body said maintaining sanitation in and around the venue was important to ensure that public spaces remained clean and aesthetically maintained after the event.

Appeal to citizens

The MCD has also urged residents and visitors to avoid littering in public places and dispose of waste only at designated locations.

The civic body said citizen participation was essential for achieving the objective of making Delhi cleaner and garbage-free. It appealed to people to support the 'Delhi Ko Kude Se Azaadi' campaign by adopting responsible waste disposal practices and keeping public spaces clean.

MODI RECALLS HIS DISCUSSIONS WITH JAPANESE PM

PM Modi meets Japanese defence minister, stresses on boosting ties

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 20

Defence Minister of Japan Shinjiro Koizumi on Thursday called on Prime Minister Narendra Modi who outlined his vision for further strengthening the Special Strategic and Global Partnership between the two countries.

During the meeting, Modi recalled his detailed discussions with Japa-

nese Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi during her visit to India for the 16th India Japan Annual Summit in July 2026 and appreciated the steady momentum in defence collaboration between the two countries.

“Japan’s Minister of Defence Shinjiro Koizumi, who is on an official visit to India, called on Prime Minister Narendra Modi today,” a statement issued by the Prime Minister’s Office said.

Modi outlined his vision for further strengthening the Special Strategic and Global Partnership between India and Japan and highlighted the importance of India-Japan defence and security cooperation in furthering peace, stability and prosperity in the Indo-Pacific and beyond, the statement said.

Later, in a post on X, the prime minister said he was pleased to receive Defence



Japan’s Defence Minister Shinjiro Koizumi accorded a Guard of Honour, in New Delhi, Thursday

Minister of Japan Shinjiro Koizumi.

“Had an excellent conversation on deepening

defence and security ties between India and Japan. Our Special Strategic and Global Partnership is an important anchor for peace, stability and prosperity in the Indo-Pacific and beyond,” Modi said.

The Prime Minister outlined opportunities for Japan to partner with Indian companies and start-ups in the defence sector, particularly for co-development and co-pro-

duction under ‘Make in India’ initiative.

Defence Minister Koizumi briefed the prime minister about the progress in bilateral defence cooperation and reaffirmed the government of Japan’s continued commitment towards deepening ties with India, the statement said.

Meanwhile, a high-level Japanese delegation, including Yamanashi Gov-

ernor Kotaro Nagasaki and around 240 CEOs of Japanese companies, visited the Taj Mahal here on Thursday.

The delegation spent around an hour at the iconic monument, admiring its architecture and beauty.

Uttar Pradesh Tourism minister Jaiver Singh received the delegation and accompanied its members during the visit.

From page 1

SC forms 5-member

the use of excessive force and violence against protesters by police, including the deployment of pellet guns, as well as the alleged use of force and violence by protesters against police officials and other security personnel.

The top court clarified that as a matter of abundant caution, the enquiry undertaken by the HPEC shall not be a one-time exercise. It asked the committee to undertake a continuous and periodic assessment of the issues and shall submit its interim findings periodically.

The apex court recommended that the HPEC should address certain issues on a priority basis, foremost amongst which is the matter relating to the alleged incidents of targeted violence, harassment and molestation of female protesters.

The HPEC may also examine issues about granting interim compensation to those injured on either side, whether police personnel or protesters, it said. The top court also asked the HPEC to submit a report on damage caused to public property resulting from the protesters’ actions during the demonstrations.

This includes the destruction of and injury to government installations, vehicles and other assets belonging to the State and to private citizens alike.

The injuries sustained by the police forces while discharging their duties, as well as the consequent mental and emotional trauma borne by their families, merit due recognition and consideration on a par with the grievances raised by the petitioners.

The apex court granted liberty to parties to approach the HPEC and submit such relevant material, documentary evidence, and suggestions as they may deem fit.

Liberty is also granted to complainants, representations and material to be provided anonymously so that the identity of the complainants and witnesses is protected, it added.

The top court also appointed advocates Ashima Mandla, Daksh Kadian and Astha Singh as nodal officers for better communication between parties.

The bench directed the police, paramilitary forces and other investigating agencies to preserve all CCTV footage, drone footage, body-worn camera recordings, videography, wireless communication records and PCR call logs pertaining to the student protests, furnish the entire record to the HPEC and extend their full cooperation.

“It is further clarified that the constitution of the HPEC by us shall in no way deter or debar the police authorities or other security forces from taking administrative or disciplinary action against such of their officers as may be found to be in contravention of the rules governing their conduct,” the bench said.

Centre allows

to hold stocks exceeding their requirement for 15 days.

The Food Ministry has issued the Sugar (Stockholding Limit of Bulk Consumers) Order, 2026, covering confectioners, soft drink manufacturers, food processing units, sweetmeat sellers

and other institutional buyers. The order will take effect from September 1 and remain in force until November 30.

A bulk consumer is defined as an institutional buyer whose average monthly sugar consumption has been at least 10 tonnes over the previous year, excluding the current month.

“The proactive step taken by the government will immediately dispel speculation & ensure adequate supply to consumers at reasonable and stable prices over the coming year,” the Food Ministry said in a post on X.

The latest measures come as sugar prices have risen sharply amid concerns about opening stocks before the 2026-27 season, which starts on October 1. According to an industry body, the all-India average ex-mill price increased to Rs 5,400-5,500 per quintal on Tuesday, compared with Rs 3,900 a year earlier.

Retail prices have also moved higher. Consumer Affairs Ministry data showed the average retail price at Rs 52.30 per kg on August 18, around 13 per cent above the Rs 46.34 recorded a year earlier.

Sugar consumption generally increases between August and November because of the festival season, including Ganesh Chaturthi, Dussehra and Diwali.

Industry estimates suggest opening stocks for the new sugar season could be around 40-42 lakh tonnes. Some researchers have estimated a lower level of 32-35 lakh tonnes. Both estimates are below the country’s expected domestic requirement of about 50 lakh tonnes.

The stockholding measure follows an earlier government order that came into effect on August 1 and limits sugar dealers to holding 4,000 quintals for 30 days until November 30.

Alongside the import decision, the DGFT issued procedures for allocating the 10 lakh MT TRQ and allowing a one-time conversion from the Advance Authorisation Scheme to the TRQ Scheme.

Applications will be accepted online from August 21 to August 28. Only millers and refiners with their own functional facilities to process raw sugar into white or refined sugar can apply. Applicants must submit a self-declaration of refining capacity along with evidence, including a Consent to Operate issued by the relevant State Pollution Control Board.

The DGFT said preference would be given to applicants undertaking to complete their imports by October 15. Failure to use or surrender the allocated quantity within the prescribed period will be treated as non-compliance.

Relief for 450

considered after the investigation is completed and the case is decided.

Advocate Amritansh Vats, appearing for the petitioners, said the court had prima facie stayed both sets of notifications. He said Justice Roshan observed that the cancellation orders appeared to violate the principle of natural justice. Vats said the order would provide relief to around 450 candidates.

The hearing began at 3:30 pm before a packed courtroom, with lawyers, government employees and candidates affected by the notifications present.

The order also brought relief to 54 candidates selected as food safety officers. Several of them gathered outside the state sec-

retariat after the hearing.

Aniket Dwivedi, posted in Simdega, said he had resigned as an agriculture development officer with the Haryana government to join government service in his home state.

“We will join duty from tomorrow. Injustice will not be tolerated,” said Rohit Kumar, a Food Safety Officer posted in Garhwa.

Anjali Nibha Minz said, “Finally, we got relief. We will be joining our duties from Friday at our respective places of posting.”

Asha Raj, posted in Gumla, said the food safety examination was among 22 examinations cancelled by the government.

The cancellations came amid a 25-day students’ agitation over alleged irregularities in recruitment examinations. On the night of August 18, the JMM-led government cancelled 22 examinations and ordered probes into 23 others conducted since 2014.

SC: 1978 ‘industry’

pending or already decided matters under the 1947 Act.

“The future of ‘industry’ in section 2(p) of 2020 Code is not burdened by the interpretation of 2(j) in the Industrial Disputes Act of 1947,” Chief Justice Surya Kant said.

He added that pending proceedings before courts, tribunals, labour authorities or other forums under the 1947 Act must be decided according to the interpretation of Section 2(j) laid down in the 1978 Bangalore Water Supply judgment.

Justice Narasimha agreed that the authoritative interpretation of Section 2(j) had lost its relevance for future cases following the introduction of the new labour code. The majority also made clear that it had not examined the provisions of the 2020 Code itself.

Justice Nagarathna disagreed with the majority and held that the reference against the 1978 judgment was unwarranted and not maintainable. In her dissent, she referred to the transformation of India’s industrial economy from state-owned enterprises to an environment shaped by privatisation, liberalisation and globalisation.

“Liberalisation and privatisation were meant for the welfare of the people of India,” she said, adding that the changes were adopted to transfer state-sponsored and managed industries, goods and services to private hands.

Justice Datta, writing for himself and Justice Bhuyan, also held that the 1978 judgment did not warrant reconsideration. “Institutional credibility lies in respecting finality and not in perpetuating doubt,” he said.

Justice Bagchi accepted that the reference was maintainable but agreed with Justice Nagarathna that the 1978 judgment had correctly determined the scope of “industry”. The detailed judgment is awaited.

The 1978 ruling had significantly widened the scope of the term, bringing workers in hospitals, educational institutions, clubs and government welfare departments within the protection of the Industrial Disputes Act.

The nine-judge bench had framed the issues for consideration on February 16. These included whether the test in paragraphs 140 to 144 of Justice Krishna Iyer’s opinion correctly stated the law, and whether the

Industrial Disputes (Amendment) Act, 1982 and the Industrial Relations Code, 2020 affected the interpretation of “industry”. The bench also considered whether social welfare activities and schemes run by government departments or their instrumentalities could qualify as industrial activities under Section 2(j) of the 1947 Act.

The Industrial Relations Code came into effect on November 21, 2025, making the Supreme Court’s distinction between old and new proceedings significant for cases arising under the two legal frameworks.

Sajjan Kumar

the killing of five Sikhs and the burning of a gurdwara during the 1984 violence. He resigned from the Congress after his conviction.

In February 2025, a Delhi court handed Kumar another life sentence in a separate case involving the killing of two Sikh men during the riots.

The violence followed the assassination of then prime minister Indira Gandhi by her Sikh bodyguards on October 31, 1984. Thousands were killed across India, with Delhi among the worst affected.

The Nanavati Commission recorded 587 FIRs in Delhi, of which 28 resulted in convictions. About 50 people were convicted for murder, including Kumar.

Kumar is survived by his wife, two daughters and a son. His cremation will be held in Delhi on Friday.

The Haryana Congress Legislature Party, meeting in Chandigarh under former chief minister Bhupinder Singh Hooda, condoled his death and observed silence in his memory.

UGC equity

their language as “prima facie vague” and warning that they could have “very sweeping consequences” and a “dangerous impact” by potentially dividing society.

The court had also directed that the UGC’s 2012 equity regulations would remain in force until further orders under Article 142 of the Constitution.

The 2026 rules have faced protests at several places, with student groups and other organisations calling for their withdrawal.

During its January hearing, the Supreme Court questioned the need for a separate definition of “caste-based discrimination” under Regulation 3(l) (c), when Regulation 3(l)(e) already contains a broad definition of “discrimination”. It also questioned why ragging was excluded despite being a common form of harassment in educational institutions.

The court had said the wording could be “capable of misuse”.

Advocate Vishnu Shankar Jain, representing one of the petitioners, had challenged Regulation 3(l)(c), which defines caste-based discrimination as discrimination “only on the basis of caste or tribe” against members of Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and Other Backward Classes.

Delhi Master Plan 2047

been eased by reducing the minimum plot size from 40,000 sq m to 3,000 sq m, a move expected to facilitate around

seven lakh additional dwelling units. The plan also provides a 50% FAR incentive for affordable rental housing and an additional 15% FAR for workers’ housing on industrial plots of 5,000 sq m and above.

Addressing the event, Manohar Lal said the plan had been prepared keeping Delhi’s future requirements in mind. “Keeping in view Delhi’s growing population and the need for its holistic development, the Delhi Master Plan 2047 will prove to be a milestone in shaping the future of the national capital,” he said. He added that the plan envisages around 40 lakh affordable housing units, incorporates a Transit-Oriented Development policy to strengthen public transport corridors and encourages resident welfare associations to undertake redevelopment of existing colonies.

Under the Land Pooling Policy, nearly 200 sq km has been identified for planned urban expansion to create around 12 lakh homes, supported by a 600-km road network. The policy provides for infrastructure-first development by DDA, implementation through town planning schemes, high-density development with FAR up to 400 along a 250-metre-wide UER-II corridor, and identifies Sector 8B in Zone P-II (Village Gadi Khashro and Ibrahimpur) as the first notified sector for implementation.

The Master Plan also proposes redevelopment of commercial centres on plots of 1,000 sq m and above with higher FAR incentives, mixed-use development along roads with 30-metre right of way and above, flexible industrial zoning, permission for warehouses, e-commerce, big-box retail, co-working spaces and data centres, and simplification of land-use regulations by reducing 133 use premises to 45 through a negative-list approach. On the environmental front, it proposes ecological restoration of around 1,700 hectares of the Yamuna floodplain through 13 restoration projects, development of a 52-km cycle track along the river, expansion of sewage treatment infrastructure, promotion of rooftop solar, rainwater harvesting, water recycling and net-zero development. It also includes conservation of around 1,500 heritage assets, introduction of Transferable Development Rights (TDR) incentives for heritage conservation, development of 138 hectares in Narela as an education hub, and promotion of Dwarka as an investment hub for IT, start-ups, industrial parks and data centres.

The plan further proposes expansion of the Delhi Metro network from around 416 km to 695 km, multimodal transit hubs integrating Metro, RRTS and buses, development of UER-I, UER-II and UER-III, a unified metropolitan transport authority, a unified parking framework, GIS-based planning, online approvals, park connectors, planned development of around 150 sq km of low-density areas, redevelopment of Kartavya Path’s surrounding capital district, and development of the Yuge Yuge National Museum.

LG Taranjit Singh Sandhu said the plan provides “a robust roadmap for vertical growth, transit-oriented development and quality housing” while promoting education, healthcare, heritage conservation and sustainable development. He said the focus should now be on translating the planning frame-

work into visible outcomes that improve the ease of living.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta described the document as “a comprehensive roadmap for the overall development of Delhi”, saying it addresses the needs of villages, unauthorised colonies, old residential areas, markets, slum settlements, transport, pollution and civic infrastructure. She said, “The Master Plan has made the way easier for redevelopment of residential colonies with higher FAR and better facilities,” and added that it would give further momentum to “Jahan Jhuggi, Wahan Makan.” She also said the plan simplifies development procedures through GIS-linked land-use planning, online approvals and fewer land-use categories, while creating opportunities for emerging sectors such as data centres, startup hubs and co-working spaces.

Among other provisions, the Master Plan provides for regularisation of residential buildings in 1,511 unauthorised colonies on an “as is where is” basis without requiring layout plans, a measure projected to provide greater property ownership security to around 45 lakh residents.

Bank employee

recovered a WhatsApp status in which the man accused his wife of cheating on him.

The incident began when SBI field officer Manas Bajpai, 35, reached the ICICI Bank office in the afternoon and called his wife Divya Mishra, 33, outside. According to preliminary information, the two spoke for some time before Manas allegedly shot Divya and fled the spot.

He then drove about two kilometres to his rented house near Husadiya Chauraha, where he lived with his sister Siba, 28. Witnesses said Manas appeared drenched in sweat when he reached home. He went inside, locked the room and allegedly shot his sister. He then turned the gun on himself.

Hearing gunshots, neighbours reached the house and broke open the door. They found Manas and Siba lying in a pool of blood. A Hanuman Chalisa was playing at high volume on the television inside the room.

Police officers, including Lucknow Police Commissioner Tarun Gaba, reached the spot soon after the incident. A forensic team was examining the crime scene and collecting evidence. Police said the exact sequence of events and the motive were being investigated.

According to the WhatsApp status attributed to Manas, he claimed that he had killed his wife because she had allegedly betrayed him. He also mentioned his intention to kill himself and his sister and named Divya’s sister Pragya and her husband Bharat Yadav, claiming that they knew about the matter.

Divya worked as an assistant manager at ICICI Bank and was posted as a relationship manager. She was the sister of You-Tuber Pragya Mishra. Divya and Manas had been married for around 12 years and had no children.

Sources said Divya had filed for divorce in court about a year ago and had been living separately in Alambagh since then.

Manas was posted as a field officer at the SBI Engineering College branch and had been living with his sister in a rented house near Husadiya Chauraha. His parents are no longer alive.

Police are questioning people

known to the family and examining the WhatsApp status, CCTV footage and other evidence to establish what led to the killings. The bodies have been sent for post-mortem examination.

6-yr-old collapses,

The exact cause of death has not been established, and the post-mortem report is awaited.

CCTV footage obtained by authorities shows the teacher scolding the child. He is then seen crying and moving his hands repeatedly, apparently pleading with her. The footage shows the teacher adjusting his shirt and pants before slapping him. Seconds later, the child collapses into her lap. The teacher appears to try to lift him while remaining seated, but he does not respond.

Police are examining the footage and questioning people who were present at the school as part of the investigation.

The family alleged that the child was taken to hospital after he had already died and demanded strict action against the teacher and the school management. The child’s father said he did not receive any call from the school and learned about the incident from local cooks working at his brother-in-law’s place. The father also rejected suggestions that the child had been unwell before leaving for school that day. Police have registered a case and begun an initial inquiry under Section 194 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), which covers police inquiries into deaths occurring under unnatural or suspicious circumstances.

Andhra Pradesh Human Resources Development Minister Nara Lokesh expressed condolences over the child’s death. Calling it “heartbreaking”, Lokesh said, “We are taking legal action against the culprits and the school management.”

Addressing the parents, he added, “Stay strong. The loss you have suffered is irreplaceable by anyone. Our government will stand by you in every possible way.” The investigation is continuing, with police examining the CCTV footage and other evidence to establish the circumstances leading to the child’s death.

MP0ST

HC bench for Ladakh approved

He added that the Centre remained committed to Ladakh’s development and constitutional safeguards.

Lt Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena welcomed the decision as “historic”, thanking Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Shah. He said the bench would help ensure speedy justice and address a long-standing demand.

The decision comes as the Leh Apex Body and Kargil Democratic Alliance continue their five-year agitation for constitutional safeguards, including protections for land, employment, culture and political representation.

On Wednesday, the groups submitted a memorandum of “non-negotiable” demands to Chief Secretary Ashish Kundra. KDA co-chairman Asgar Ali Karbalai said the next formal meeting with the Centre is expected in Delhi in the first week of September.

MP0ST

Briefs

Tejashwi attacks NDA government

MADHUBANI: RJD leader Tejashwi Yadav on Thursday attacked the ruling NDA govt over alleged deterioration in law and order, saying he would not let Bihar become a “police state”.

Yadav, who is the leader of the Opposition in the Assembly, said Bihar’s law and order had “completely collapsed”, while accusing the government of failing to control “rising police brutality”.

HP: More than 150 roads closed

SHIMLA: More than 150 roads were closed for vehicular traffic in Himachal Pradesh as intermittent rains continued to lash parts of the state. The Shimla Met office has issued a yellow warning of heavy rains in isolated parts of the state till Saturday.

Around 22 transformers and 79 drinking water supply schemes have also been disrupted as of Thursday evening, according to the State Emergency Operation Centre. A total of 156 roads have been shut due to the rains.

‘Over 87K TB cases detected in Bihar’

PATNA: More than 87,600 tuberculosis (TB) cases were detected in Bihar during an intensive statewide screening campaign conducted between July 2 and August 14, a senior health official said on Thursday.

According to state health department data, officials screened 2.36 crore people against a target of one crore during the campaign.

Gangster shot dead at Hisar Court

HISAR: Gangster Vinod Pannu alias Kana was shot dead by two assailants at the main gate in the district court complex in Haryana’s Hisar on Thursday afternoon, police said.

Pannu was leaving the complex with his associates after a court hearing when the attack took place inside the complex, police said.

CJI praises Justice Karol

NEW DELHI: Chief Justice of India Surya Kant on Thursday heaped praises on Justice Sanjay Karol for his approach in life and judicial work, and said the Supreme Court will certainly feel his absence.

Speaking at the farewell function organised by Supreme Court Advocate On-Record Association (SCAORA) for Justice Karol, who is set to demit office on August 22, CJI Kant said, “It has been a privilege to know you as a colleague. This court will certainly feel your absence.”

SHIVAKUMAR FLAGS DELIMITATION

Amit Shah chairs southern CMs conclave in Chennai

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Chennai, August 20

Union Home minister Amit Shah on Thursday led the deliberations at the meeting of southern states’ chief ministers at Kovalam near here, where Karnataka CM DK Shivakumar raised the delimitation issue while CMs C Joseph Vijay and V D Satheesan had a “key interaction.”

Against the backdrop of Cauvery river water sharing issue and the Mekedatu dam row, Tamil Nadu Chief Minister Vijay, who was seated next to his Karnataka counterpart Shivakumar, spoke to him at the 31st meeting of the Southern Zonal Council.

The Southern Zonal Council comprises the states of Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka, Kerala, Tamil Nadu and Telangana, and the Union Territories of Puducherry, Andaman and Nicobar Islands and Lakshadweep. Kerala CM Satheesan, among others, attended the meeting.

In his remarks, Shivakumar urged the Southern Zonal Council to adopt a resolution calling on the Union government to honour the 1971 census as the basis for delimitation, retain the Lok Sabha’s existing strength of 543 seats for the next 25 years and accommodate women’s reservation within these existing seats.

The southern states’ success in controlling its population must not become a reason for reducing its political voice.

CM discusses Assam flood rehab with Modi
Prime Minister offers full support

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Guwahati, August 20

Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma on Thursday discussed rehabilitation measures for flood victims with Prime Minister Narendra Modi, who reiterated his commitment to give the state full support to overcome the crisis.

Sarma met Modi in New Delhi during the day and also discussed other issues upon completion of 100 days of his second term in office.

“Throughout the #AssamFloodResponse, Adarniya Modi Ji remained in constant touch, closely reviewing the situation and extending every possible assistance,” Sarma said in a social media post.

The CM said he shared with Modi the Assam government’s roadmap for the next phase -- rebuilding affected areas, restoring livelihoods and ensuring a comprehensive recovery.



Union Home minister Amit Shah with southern CMs during the 31st Meeting of the Southern Zonal Council (SZC), in Chengalpattu district, Thursday PTI

HIGHLIGHTS

- » The Southern Zonal Council comprises the states of Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka, Kerala, Tamil Nadu and Telangana, and the UTs of Puducherry, Andaman and Nicobar Islands and Lakshadweep
- » The southern states’ success in controlling its population must not become a reason for reducing its political voice

exercise.

He urged the Council to pass a resolution seeking to freeze the number of Lok Sabha seats at the existing 543 for the next 25 years and provide women’s reservation within those specific seats.

The Karnataka CM also flagged the issue of the Mekedatu project, stressing that it is important not only for his state, but for Tamil Nadu as well.

“While walking to the meeting, senior leader and Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister Chandrababu Naidu ji told me that we need to solve the Cauvery water issue between Karnataka and Tamil Nadu. Let me assure you, every drop of water from the Mekedatu project will help farmers in Tamil Nadu and Puducherry. Help us help you,” he said.

Shivakumar also linked the delimitation issue with women’s reservation, arguing that the implementation of the reservation should not be delayed on account of a fresh delimitation

respected and for the overall strength of the Lok Sabha to remain unchanged.

“I am confident that all the chief ministers here will support me in what I say. Let the 1971 basis be honoured, and let the strength of our voice be protected,” he added.

Shivakumar also linked the delimitation issue with women’s reservation, arguing that the implementation of the reservation should not be delayed on account of a fresh delimitation

Police cannot investigate offences under PCPNDT Act: SC

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 20

The Supreme Court on Thursday held that police cannot investigate offences under the Pre-Conception and Pre-Natal Diagnostic Techniques (PCPNDT) Act.

The PCPNDT Act was enacted with the intent to prohibit the use of prenatal diagnostic techniques for determination of the sex of the foetus. A bench of Justices Sanjay Karol and N Kotiswar Singh held that authorities designated under the law must take action in such cases.

The top court said the PCPNDT Act concerns matters that are technical and which may require medical knowledge and sensitivity.

“Police are not meant to be the investigators for the purposes of this Act,” the bench said, adding that police can only play a supplementary role according to the provisions.

Shah slams Cong’s two-stanza Vande Mataram decision

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 20

The row over Vande Mataram intensified on Thursday with Union Home Minister Amit Shah launching a no-holds-barred attack on the Congress, alleging that its decision to sing just two stanzas of Vande Mataram was “anti-national” and aimed at appeasing its vote bank in defiance of the law.

The Congress hit back, with senior party leader Jairam Ramesh calling BJP leaders “fraudulent nationalists” and accusing Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Shah of politicising the national song to divert attention from the government’s failures on people’s concerns, including those of students.

The war of words followed the Congress Working Committee’s decision on Wednesday to sing only two stanzas of the national song, instead of its full rendition. This widened

Oppn raises questions over NCERT panel’s composition

Accuses the government of seeking to push RSS ideological imprint on the school education

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 20

Several Opposition parties and student organisations on Thursday accused the government of seeking to push the RSS’s ideological imprint on school education after some people with links to the Sangh were named in a team constituted by NCERT tasked with writing new political science textbooks for classes 11 and 12.

Congress general secretary Jairam Ramesh accused the NCERT of carrying out “sanghikaran” of textbooks, while party MP Syed Naseer Hussain said the composition of the panel raised concerns about the political independence of the textbook development process.

Ramesh said the



NCERT now stood for “Nagpur Coterie for Educational Re-writing and Troublemaking”.

RJD Rajya Sabha member Manoj Jha questioned the inclusion of people associated with such organisations, while the National Students’ Union of India (NSUI) and the Left-affiliated All India Students’ Association (AISA) also attacked the composition of the team.

The reactions came after news agency reported on Wednesday that the NCERT had reconstituted

here. I am loved here. I am respected here and my search for truth matters” should resonate with every citizen.

Launching a sharp attack on the BJP, Gandhi alleged the party has been systematically delegitimising minority communities and marginalised groups.

“The BJP tells Muslims, Christians and Sikhs that they don’t exist. BJP tells Adivasis that their land will be taken, and if they protest, they will be shot. BJP tells Dalits that their oppression

doesn’t matter. This is what has been done to our country,” he said.

Gandhi elaborated on the concept of ‘Swaraj’, explaining it as “ruling over oneself” rather than mere “freedom”, a distinctly Indian concept that Mahatma Gandhi believed every person should pursue. Contrasting this with the RSS’s ideological approach, he said, “A group of people who control the system have decided that they know the truth for everyone in this country.”

Cong: Centre can resolve any Manipur issue if it’s determined

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Imphal, August 20

Manipur Congress chief O Ibobi Singh on Thursday asserted that the Centre can resolve any issue concerning the state, including the implementation of the National Register of Citizens (NRC), in two to three months if it has commitment and determination.

Representatives of several civil society organisations in Manipur left for New Delhi during the day to apprise Union ministers and BJP leaders of their demand for NRC updation before the conduct of Census 2027 in the state.

Singh, addressing the media, said, “If the central government wants, the implementation of NRC in Manipur is not an issue... NRC should be updated first before the Census is conducted. If required, the Constitution should be amended.”

“Ours is a very small state. If the Union government is determined and committed, be it NRC or any other issue, it is only a matter of two-three months to resolve it,” the former chief minister said. The real issue is of the Centre’s ignorance of the wishes of the people of the state, he said.

“How many houses were destroyed during the ethnic conflict? How would you then carry out house-listing as part of the Census? How would you count the 60,000 IDPs (internally displaced persons) residing in relief camps?” he said.

Meanwhile, representatives of 10 civil society organisations, including Naga and Meitei bodies, left for the national capital to press for their demand for NRC updation before the conduct of the Census in the state.

Several Parliamentary panels await reconstitution

The Ethics Committee handles complaints regarding moral or unethical behaviour of members

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 20

Several crucial Parliamentary committees, including the one which deals with the ethics of MPs, are yet to be reconstituted after the terms of previous panels ended.

According to the Lok Sabha website, multiple panels -- ranging from the Rules Committee to the Ethics Committee -- are currently awaiting formal reconstitution and the appointment of chairpersons.

While financial and major department-related standing committees are

KEY POINTS

- » According to the Lok Sabha website, multiple panels -- ranging from the Rules Committee to the Ethics Committee -- are currently awaiting formal reconstitution and the appointment of chairpersons
- » Among the panels yet to be reconstituted is the Railway Convention Committee. It evaluates financial relations between the Consolidated Fund of India and Railway finances

reconstituted periodically, internal and ad hoc parliamentary panels have experienced administrative delays.

Among the panels yet to be reconstituted is the Railway Convention

Committee.

It evaluates financial relations between the Consolidated Fund of India and Railway finances.

The Committee on Violation of Protocol



Norms and Contemptuous Behaviour of Government Officers with Members of Lok Sabha is also headless. It investigates complaints regarding misconduct by civil servants towards MPs.

The Ethics Committee handles complaints regarding moral or unethical behaviour of members.

The General Purposes Committee is also not in place. It advises the speaker on internal House matters and operational rules.

Other committees that are yet to be reconstituted are the Papers Laid on the Table Committee, which ensures government papers and reports submitted to the House comply with statutory provisions; and the Private Members’ Bills and Resolutions Committee, which scrutinises

and allocates time for non-official Bills introduced by MPs.

The Rules Committee, which recommends updates and amendments to the procedures governing Lok Sabha business, also remains headless.

The House Committee, which oversees residential accommodations and amenities provided to MPs, is also awaiting reconstitution.

The Joint Committee on Offices of Profit is pending reconstitution. It examines whether holding certain offices disqualifies an MP under Article 102.

Briefs

Tarun Tejpal moves SC

NEW DELHI: Journalist Tarun Tejpal on Thursday moved the Supreme Court challenging the Bombay High Court's August 6 verdict convicting him in a 2013 sexual assault case. Tejpal, through advocate Aditya Samaddar, challenged his 10-year rigorous imprisonment sentence. The Goa government has also approached the apex court seeking enhancement of the sentence to life term.

Guwahati-Silchar Exp cancelled...

MALIGAON: North-east Frontier Railway has cancelled the Guwahati-Silchar Express on August 21 and Silchar-Guwahati Express on August 22 amid restoration work near New Harangajao. The Narangi-Agartala Express, Rangiya-Silchar Express and Sairang-Anand Vihar Terminal Express have also been rescheduled. Train operations over the Lumding-Badarpur Hill Section are being maintained through Line-3 with enhanced safety measures.

Hooda slams govt over HKRN row

CHANDIGARH: Former Haryana Chief Minister Bhupinder Hooda accused the BJP government of exploiting youth through the Haryana Kaushal Rozgar Nigam (HKRN) and demanded regularisation of all employees with equal pay, DA, promotions, reservation and other benefits. He said Congress would submit a memorandum to the Governor and demanded abolition of HKRN.

Jauhar Univ case: ED raids 10 sites

NEW DELHI: The Enforcement Directorate on Wednesday searched 10 locations in Rampur, Saharanpur and Delhi in a money laundering case linked to alleged illegal land acquisition and misappropriation of government funds at Mohammad Ali Jauhar University. The ED said it seized documents, 'fraudulent' donation details and data linked to case.

Saini calls for social harmony

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Thursday said Sant Shriromani Guru Ravidas Ji's teachings have guided humanity for centuries and called for strengthening social harmony and equality. Addressing a statue installation ceremony at Jadaula village in Kaithal, Saini announced a Rs 31 lakh grant for the Sant Guru Ravidas Welfare Committee.

PEACE BID AFTER SHILLONG VIOLENCE

Meghalaya and Assam CMs agree to 'work together' to restore peace

MPOST BUREAU

Guwahati, August 20

Meghalaya Chief Minister Conrad K Sangma and his Assam counterpart Himanta Biswa Sarma on Thursday agreed to work together to restore peace and normalcy following violent clashes during a Khasi Students' Union (KSU) bike rally in Shillong that left 16 people injured and damaged 31 vehicles.

The two chief ministers held talks over Wednesday's violence and its fallout, particularly attacks on Assam-registered vehicles, amid heightened security in Shillong and along the Meghalaya-Assam border. Sangma said he discussed the "unfortunate violence" with Sarma and its impact on common people and commuters of both states. He said designated Cabinet ministers from Meghalaya and Assam would meet to take the discussions forward and explore ways to restore "peace, trust and normalcy".

Sarma said he conveyed Assam's concern over the incidents, particularly those involving vehicles registered in the neighbouring state. He asked Assam Border Protection Minister Atul Bora to coordinate closely with Meghalaya authorities to ensure peace and normalcy between the two states.



A vehicle with a shattered windshield during a protest staged by taxi drivers in Guwahati

PTI

HIGHLIGHTS

- » The Centre approved the deployment of five companies of central forces in Meghalaya till Aug 25
- » Meghalaya HC took suo motu cognisance and directed authorities to take prompt steps to apprehend those involved
- » 15 FIRs have been registered in connection with the violence
- » Protests over the violence disrupted Assam-Meghalaya road communication on Thursday

The Centre, meanwhile, approved the deployment of five companies of central forces in Meghalaya till August 25 to assist the state police in maintaining law and order. The Union Home Ministry cleared four companies of the Central Reserve Police Force (CRPF) and one company of the Rapid Action Force (RAF) after the Meghalaya Home (Police) Department

reported a "sudden deterioration" in the law-and-order situation in Shillong. The Meghalaya High Court also took suo motu cognisance of the violence and directed authorities to take prompt and effective steps to apprehend those involved. A division bench of Justice H S Thangkhiew and Justice W Diengdoh sought a report on the action taken by August 24.

Caste name alone does not constitute SC/ST Act offence: HC

MPOST BUREAU

Prayagraj, August 20

Merely using a caste name does not automatically constitute an offence under the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, the Allahabad High Court has observed while quashing a lower court's summons order in a case involving the alleged use of the word "Chamar".

The court said there must be prima facie material showing that the caste-related word was used with the intention or knowledge of insulting or humiliating the complainant on the ground of caste. It held that mere use of a caste name, without material indicating deliberate intent to insult or humiliate a person because of their caste, is insufficient to invoke the SC/ST Act. The HC quashed the summons order and proceedings.

The court observed that the violence had resulted in damage to government, police and commercial vehicles and allegedly endangered residents, including schoolchildren. The Advocate General informed the court that steps had been taken and some members of the organisation arrested. Meanwhile, traffic between Assam and Meghalaya was disrupted on Thursday, after Guwahati-based cab operators blocked National Highway-27 for vehicles from the hill state, protesting against the violence.

Hundreds of passengers and Meghalaya-registered vehicles were stranded near the Assam-Meghalaya border, after the cab operators blocked the highway to voice displeasure over the violent incidents that took place during the KSU bike rally.

Police said 15 FIRs have been registered in connection with Wednesday's violence, which involved stone-pelting, vandalism, arson and assaults at several locations, including Fire Brigade, Nongmen-song, Polo, Barik and Mawlai. Two vehicles were set ablaze, while 31 vehicles were damaged.

Three senior KSU leaders – president Raymond Kharjana, vice-president Pynkmenlang Sanmiet and general secretary Reuben

Najiar – were arrested and remanded in 14 days' judicial custody. They were booked under various provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita in connection with alleged damage to public property, assault and other offences.

The arrests came hours after KSU leaders expressed regret over the violence but denied that its members were involved in vandalism and arson. They alleged that "vested interests" had infiltrated the rally to sabotage the organisation's agitation.

The rally was organised to press the KSU's five-point charter, including implementation of the Meghalaya Residents Safety and Security Act, regulation of migrant workers, government recruitment reforms, action regarding recruitment at NEIGRI-HMS, cancellation of the July 31 public hearing for a proposed Shree Cement project in East Jaintia Hills and implementation of the Inner Line Permit.

Police have intensified searches to identify and arrest other persons allegedly involved. The violence also saw the reported vandalism of busts of Swami Vivekananda and Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose. A midnight police raid at the KSU office in Jaiaw also drew criticism from former leaders, who alleged excessive use of force.

CBSE 3-LANGUAGE POLICY

Students must not face 'pressure': SC

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, August 20

Observing that children should not come under any kind of pressure, the Supreme Court on Thursday stressed the need to find a solution to issues arising out of the CBSE policy mandating the study of three languages by Class 9 students.

A bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana observed there was nothing wrong in introducing the policy but the only concern raised by the petitioners was about the manner in which it was being introduced.

"Some of these problems, you may revisit. There is no doubt that sooner or later, it has to be introduced. There is nothing wrong with that. But how it is to be streamlined so that whatever impediments or blockades are coming up, you may find a solution to those," the bench told Additional Solicitor General Aishwarya Bhati.

The bench said one of the aspects that was required to be considered was how to build adequate human resource infrastructure with regard to the language options available.

"If you have chosen Class 6 as the starting point, you may consider giving a reprieve to Class 6 students of this year. You

TOP COURT STRESSED THE NEED TO FIND A SOLUTION TO ISSUES ARISING OUT OF THE CBSE POLICY

can introduce it from next year," it said.

"Another thing which needs to be looked into is where do you draw the line. Whether it is Class 6, Class 4 or Class 3. You can take a call depending on the curriculum and where the choice between two and three languages is first introduced," the bench said.

It said one of the concerns was whether we consider English a native language or a foreign language.

"As the Union of India, you will also have to see that other than the CBSE, what is happening in other boards," the bench told Bhati, adding that it has to be ensured that the roll-out of the policy is appropriately undertaken.

Bhati said she would take instructions on the suggestions and get back to the court.

"We don't want the children to come under any pressure," the CJI said.

The top court was hearing a batch of pleas challenging the CBSE's policy mandating the study of three languages, including two native Indian languages, for Class 9 students from July 1.

Guj spurious liquor tragedy: Toll rises to 7

MPOST BUREAU

Bhavnagar, August 20

The death toll from consumption of spurious liquor in Gujarat's Bhavnagar district rose to seven on Thursday, while 30 people are undergoing treatment, police said.

Inspector General of Police, Bhavnagar Range, R V Asari said 12 bootleggers have been detained so far and an FIR has been registered against 21 people in connection with the incident. The victims allegedly consumed spurious liquor packed in duplicate bottles of a popular Indian-Made Foreign Liquor (IMFL) brand. The incident came to light after five friends fell ill during a party at Kharakadi village in Ghogha taluka on Tuesday evening.

"Seven persons have died after consuming spurious liquor, and 30 are undergoing treatment," Asari said.

He said a case of accidental death was initially registered after a person died following consumption of toxic, chemical-laced liquor in Kharakadi village, under Vartej police station limits. An FIR was subsequently lodged against 21 accused.

Police said the condition of several victims deteriorated after they consumed liquor from the duplicate bottles. Examination of the victims also indicated a common pattern, with most of them having consumed liquor from bottles carrying the same brand.

Preliminary investigation has suggested that the duplicate bottles were supplied from Madhya Pradesh. Police are probing their exact source, how they were manufactured and who supplied them to Bhavnagar.

India & Japan deepen defence ties amid China muscle-flexing

MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, August 20

India and Japan on Thursday signed an agreement to strengthen maritime security cooperation and agreed to deepen bilateral military ties to contribute to a free and open Indo-Pacific, amid growing military assertiveness by China in the region.

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh and his Japanese counterpart Shinjiro Koizumi expressed strong opposition to unilateral actions that impede freedom and safety of navigation and overflight, as well as attempts to alter the status quo through force or coercion.

The two ministers signed a Memorandum of Arrangement (MoA) on maritime security cooperation, providing a framework to enhance collaboration between the Indian Navy and Japan Maritime Self-Defense Force. The pact includes



Defence minister Rajnath Singh and his Japanese counterpart Shinjiro Koizumi hold copies of pact signed during Defence Ministers' Meet in New Delhi

information sharing on maritime domain awareness and greater cooperation in areas such as search and rescue.

India and Japan also agreed to explore joint naval shipbuilding and design by leveraging Japan's technological expertise and India's production capabilities under the Make in India initiative. They further decided to establish a working group, headed at the director-general/joint secretary level, to advance cooperation in

operational, intelligence, equipment, technology and industrial domains.

The two sides agreed to maximise synergies in mine countermeasures and promote reciprocal access to ship repair facilities, including through a ship repair arrangement expected to be concluded in the near future. The ministers also backed greater coordination for protecting sea lines of communication through mutual naval visits, joint exercises, personnel and expert exchanges.

Varanasi: Cremations shift to rooftops as Ganga swells

Flood-like conditions prevail in 13 UP districts, more than 84,000 people affected

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

Varanasi, August 20

The worsening flood situation in Varanasi has forced some families to perform last rites on rooftops as the rising Ganga inundated lanes and residential areas near the river, disrupting access to traditional cremation grounds.

Manikarnika Ghat, one of the country's prominent cremation grounds, has been closed after the river rose sharply and submerged the cremation area.

Parts of Harishchandra Ghat have also been affected, leaving families

KEY POINTS

- » Manikarnika Ghat, one of the country's prominent cremation grounds, has been closed after the river rose sharply
- » Parts of Harishchandra Ghat have also been affected, leaving families struggling to perform cremations amid the flooding
- » In Prayagraj, intermittent rain over the past four days has worsened waterlogging in several localities



struggling to perform cremations amid the flooding.

With several lanes near the ghats waterlogged, people have been forced to wade through water to reach their homes. In

some areas, families have resorted to carrying out cremations at alternative locations, including rooftops, as access to the traditional ghats remains severely restricted.

The continuing rains have pushed the Ganga and other rivers in eastern Uttar Pradesh towards dangerous levels. Low-lying settlements and narrow lanes along Varanasi's

ghats have been particularly affected.

The flood situation has also worsened in neighbouring districts. Officials said 13 districts are facing flood-like conditions, affecting more than 84,000 people.

In Prayagraj, intermittent rain over the past four days has worsened waterlogging in several localities. Water has entered homes in Daraganj, Kareli and Salori, with reports of water reaching around three feet in some houses. More than 2,000 students have reportedly vacated hostels, while over 7,000 families are staying with

relatives.

The Allahabad High Court has directed Prayagraj District Magistrate Manish Verma to ensure that water is drained from urban areas within 24 to 48 hours.

The flood threat has also reached other religious towns. In Chitrakoot, the Mandakini river has crossed the danger mark and floodwater has reached roads, while the Saryu in Ayodhya and water levels in Gonda have also raised concern.

With more rain forecast, authorities are monitoring rivers and vulnerable areas.

EDITORIAL

Holding the Line

The Reserve Bank of India's latest Monetary Policy Committee minutes contain a warning that should not be lost in the comfort of relatively resilient economic growth. The immediate message is that the period of monetary easing may have run its course. Policymakers see limited room for further rate cuts and are increasingly alert to the possibility that persistent inflationary pressures could eventually require tightening. That does not mean a rate increase is imminent. It does mean that the balance of risks has changed. Inflation can appear manageable at the headline level while pressures build underneath through food prices, energy costs, imported inputs and services. For households, particularly those with modest incomes, even a relatively small acceleration in essential prices can quickly erode purchasing power. The RBI is therefore right to resist the temptation to treat every moderation in inflation as an invitation to make money cheaper. Monetary policy must remain forward-looking because waiting until inflation has become entrenched makes the eventual correction considerably more painful.

The most obvious threat comes from energy. India imports most of the crude oil it consumes, leaving the economy exposed whenever geopolitical tensions send international prices higher. Expensive crude does not remain confined to petrol pumps. It raises transportation and logistics costs, increases expenses for industries dependent on petroleum products and places pressure on the rupee and the current account. Eventually, some of these additional costs are passed on to consumers. Food inflation presents a different but equally difficult challenge. Weather disruptions, uneven rainfall, crop losses and supply bottlenecks can produce sharp price movements that interest rates themselves cannot fix. The danger emerges when such temporary shocks begin spreading across the economy. Businesses facing higher input costs raise prices, workers seek compensation for rising living expenses and inflation expectations begin adjusting upwards. At that stage, what began as an external or seasonal shock can become a broader and more persistent inflation problem. The RBI's caution is intended to prevent precisely such a transition.

This does not make higher interest rates desirable. Tightening would raise borrowing costs for households and businesses, potentially weakening consumption, housing demand and private investment. The objective should therefore be to avoid creating conditions in which the RBI is forced to act aggressively. That responsibility cannot rest with monetary policy alone. The government can help through better food-stock management, faster intervention against supply disruptions, sensible fuel taxation and fiscal discipline. Improving agricultural logistics and reducing unnecessary bottlenecks can also soften food-price shocks before they spread. India needs growth, but durable growth cannot be built by tolerating persistent inflation. Price stability protects household incomes, preserves savings and gives businesses greater certainty when making investment decisions. The RBI's warning should consequently be understood as preventive rather than pessimistic. If inflationary pressures ease, rates can remain supportive. But if oil, food and input costs continue climbing, preserving price stability must come before the attraction of cheaper credit.

LETTER



letter2editor.mp@gmail.com.

Fair Inquiry

Allegations of police excesses against protesting students deserve an independent and credible examination. The Supreme Court-appointed committee must establish what happened without prejudging either protesters or police personnel. Its findings should help ensure that legitimate dissent is protected while law enforcement remains proportionate, accountable and respectful of constitutional freedoms.

NOEL FRANCIS, KERALA

You can also send your comments to The Editor, Millennium Post, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

ROOTS OF FREEDOM



JOHN FELIX RAJ & PRABHAT KUMAR DATTA

JF RAJ IS THE VC, PK DATTA IS AN ADJUNCT PROFESSOR AT ST XAVIER'S UNIVERSITY, KOLKATA

While mainstream political historiography often traces republicanism exclusively to the philosophies of Ancient Greece and Rome, a broader historical lens reveals rich, indigenous traditions of self-governance across ancient civilisations. Classically defined by popular sovereignty, civic virtue, and the rule of law, the term "republic" gained prominent Western currency only in the late 18th century, famously championed during the American and French Revolutions. However, long before the rise of Western constitutional republics, the Indian subcontinent—*Bharat Varsha*—fostered vibrant traditions of autonomous village governance, deliberative assemblies, and proto-democratic structures known as *ganarajyas*. **Vedic Period and Clan Confederacies**

The foundations of Indian civic participation trace back to the Vedic period, which saw the emergence of local associations (*goshthi*) and powerful popular assemblies like the *sabha* and *samiti*. These bodies held significant checks and balances over early monarchs.

Beyond centralised kingdoms, several independent tribal polities flourished:

- **Vriji Confederation:** A powerful alliance of Kshatriya clans, most notably the Licchavis.
- **Malla:** A prominent republican confederation known for its decentralised administration.
- **Shakyas and Koliyas:** Renowned clan republics that governed collectively through tribal assemblies.

Golden Age of 'Ganarajyas'

Republican policies reached their zenith during the Buddhist period. Buddhist texts, the grammatical rules of Panini and Kautilya's *Arthashastra* bear extensive witness to the existence of numerous *sanghas* (corporate bodies) and *ganas* (republics) across northern India.

In chapter 8 of the *Shanti Parva* of the Mahabharata, Yudhishthira specifically consults Bhishma regarding the functioning and defence of the *ganas*, underscoring their strategic and political importance. By the sixth century BCE, these terms signified self-governing multitudes where political decisions were forged through open debate and collective consensus.

Administrative and Voting Procedures

The Pali Canon—specifically within the *Maha-parinibbana-suttanta*, the *Mahavagga*, and the *Kullavagga*—preserves detailed guidelines for the Buddhist monastic brotherhood (*sangha*). These texts provide some of the earliest historical records of:

- Formal voting procedures in a corporate assembly.
- Strict membership criteria and quorum requirements.
- Participatory deliberation, which prominent Pali scholar T.W. Rhys-Davids noted was mirrored in the tribal moots and parliaments of the era.

Classical and Foreign Accounts

Foreign chroniclers corroborate this indigenous landscape.

- **Megasthenes**, the Greek ambassador to Chandragupta Maurya around 300 BCE, docu-



Behind India's democracy lies a much older political inheritance

INDIA'S REPUBLICAN HERITAGE PREDATES THE GREAT DEMOCRATIC REVOLUTIONS OF EUROPE

mented that the entire northern half of the Indian subcontinent was heavily dominated by autonomous republics.

- Arrian, in *Anabasis of Alexander*, described the Macedonian conqueror encountering "free and independent" Indian communities at every turn, a prevalence echoed in the writings of Diodorus Siculus.

However, much like the citizen assemblies of classical Athens, these ancient Indian republics often functioned as exclusive entities or closed political clubs, wherein economic expansion eventually empowered new

merchant and artisan groups to demand a share in sovereignty.

Allegorical Lessons in the Panchatantra

Reflecting the deep imprint of popular governance on the cultural consciousness, the *Panchatantra* contrasts a *ganarajya* (republic) with a *samrajya* (monarchy). It allegorically likens a republic to a cooperative herd of animals or a flock of birds, while portraying an autocratic kingdom as a solitary lion reliant on scavengers.

The Village as a "Little Republic"

In the 19th century, British legal scholar Sir Henry Maine, while advising the colonial government, observed thriving indigenous systems of autonomous village governments across the subcontinent. He famously designated them "*little republics*," noting their deep structural roots in participatory democracy. Historians like R.S. Sharma have similarly marshalled evidence showing how monarchical authority in ancient India was constantly tempered by self-ruling guilds, villages, and extended kin groups.

Constitutional Perfection in South India

One of the most remarkable blueprints for ancient democratic administration comes from South India. Epigraphical discoveries from the renovation of the Sri Sundaravaradaraja Perumal Temple in Uthiramerur (Kanchipuram district, Tamil Nadu)—originally built during the Pallava rule around 750 CE and later expanded by Rajendra Chola and Krishnadevaraya—reveal that the village operated under a written constitution.

Key features of this local governance model included:

- **Strict Candidate Qualifications:** Mandated literacy, property ownership, age limits, and moral integrity.
- **Electoral Mechanics:** A sophisticated ballot-based selection process (Kudavolai system).
- **Accountability and Recall:** Clear statutory clauses for disqualification and the immediate recall of elected representatives found incompetent.
- **Term Limits:** Contesting elections was restricted to prevent political monopoly.

Bridging Ancient Heritage and Modern Aspirations

The historical legacy of Indian republicanism was undeniably constrained by social stratifications, much like Athenian democracy was limited by the institution of slavery. Because these indigenous traditions of debate and decentralisation operated differently from Western revolutions, they left a distinct imprint on global historiography.

Yet, the historical reality remains profound: long before the democratic experiments of the West, *Bharat Varsha* cultivated sophisticated systems of republican democracy, grassroots accountability, and civic participation. Acknowledging this rich democratic pedigree serves as a profound source of national pride as contemporary India builds toward a progressive and self-reliant future (*Viksit Bharat*).

Views expressed are personal

The Pariah State Effect

Netanyahu's Gaza policies risk making Israelis and Jews increasingly vulnerable worldwide

GLOBAL FALLOUT



ASIF ULLAH KHAN

THE WRITER IS A SENIOR JOURNALIST

was reportedly shot in the head with an air rifle. Israeli citizens travelling abroad increasingly find that revealing their nationality can make them targets. Ordinary Israelis – and, more dangerously, Jews with no connection to the Israeli government – are paying the price.

Thomas Friedman warned about precisely this danger in a remarkably prescient column last year. He argued that Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's ugly, nihilistic policy in Gaza risked turning Israel into a global pariah. More ominously, he warned that Israel could cease to be seen by Jews as a safe haven from antisemitism and instead become "a new engine generating it." He imagined a future in which Jews abroad would increasingly need security around synagogues and Jewish institutions and in which Israelis might prefer to emigrate to countries such as Australia and the United States rather than encourage fellow Jews to move to Israel.

What happened in Greece was not an isolated incident. In October 2023, in Dagestan, hundreds of people stormed the airport in Makhachkala after a flight from Tel Aviv landed, searching for Jewish passengers. The mob poured onto the tarmac and tried to identify passengers arriving from Israel. This was not simply a demonstration against Netanyahu or Israel's policy in Gaza.

A year later came the murder of Rabbi Zvi Kogan in the United Arab Emirates. Kogan, an Israeli-Moldovan citizen and Chabad rabbi living in the UAE, disappeared in November 2024 and was subsequently found murdered.



What began in Gaza is now casting shadows far beyond

THE ISRAELI PASSPORT IS INCREASINGLY BECOMING A POLITICAL IDENTITY RATHER THAN MERELY A NATIONALITY

The circumstances were particularly disturbing because the UAE had been held up as a model of coexistence after establishing diplomatic relations with Israel under the Abraham Accords. The killing demonstrated how quickly the regional conflict could spill over into the lives of Jews living outside Israel.

Then came the scenes in Europe. In Amsterdam in November 2024, violence surrounding a football match involving Macabi Tel Aviv supporters shocked

Europe and revived fears about antisemitism. In Greece, the hostility has taken a different form. In July 2025, more than 150 pro-Palestinian demonstrators prevented Israeli tourists aboard a cruise ship from disembarking on the island of Syros. The protesters waved Palestinian flags and demanded an end to Israel's war in Gaza.

There is an important distinction here. Not every anti-Israel protest is antisemitic. Opposition to Netanyahu's government, condemnation of Israel's military campaign in Gaza and support for Palestinian statehood are legitimate political positions. They cannot simply be labelled antisemitic.

But when protesters move from condemning a government to targeting people because they are Israeli – or, worse, because they are believed to be Jewish – the distinction collapses.

That is what makes the Crete incident so disturbing. An Israeli family sitting in a Greek

restaurant or a rabbi living in Dubai is not responsible for Israel's military decisions. Yet increasingly, the line between Israeli identity, Jewish identity and the policies of the Israeli state is being erased.

Today, Israel has become the object of global anger, while Jews abroad can be perceived as extensions of Israel irrespective of whether they support or oppose Netanyahu. Netanyahu's policies have created a painful dilemma for the diaspora.

That is the question Netanyahu should confront: Has his government made Israel safer in the long term, or has it made Israelis – and potentially Jews everywhere – more vulnerable to hatred?

Today, the Israeli passport is increasingly becoming a political identity rather than merely a nationality. That should worry Israelis more than another hostile vote at the United Nations.

A country can survive diplomatic criticism. It can survive angry demonstrations. It can even survive periods of international isolation.

What is much harder to survive is a world in which its citizens increasingly feel compelled to hide who they are.

Friedman's warning therefore deserves to be taken seriously because Israelis increasingly face the dilemma of whether it is safe to display their identity, speak Hebrew in public or tell strangers where they come from. To be Jewish in a world where Israel has become a pariah state has not only become a source of shame but has also made Jews abroad targets of anger.

Views expressed are personal

News at a glance

Meta defends its child safety efforts at California court

CHICAGO: Meta insists it has a long history of protecting its youngest customers as it defends itself against a swath of lawsuits alleging its social media empire harms children.

The social media giant is fighting allegations in a California federal court that it contributes to the youth mental health crisis by deliberately and stealthily designing features to get children hooked on its platforms. Four states are seeking billions of dollars in damages as well as fundamental changes to how Meta runs those apps.

Six Indians aboard cargo ship hijacked off Somalia

MOGADISHU: Six Indians were aboard a Cameroon-flagged cargo ship hijacked by pirates off Somalia's Puntland coast earlier this week, a Somali official said Thursday.

The M/V LUTUF, which was carrying Turkish weapons, was seized on Monday and taken by the pirates toward the region's Nugaal coast.

The ship was seized about three and a half nautical miles off Marraya in Puntland's Eyl district, the official told The Associated Press on condition of anonymity.

Imran Khan case: Pak govt refiles review plea in SC

ISLAMABAD: The Pakistan government on Thursday refiled a review petition in the Supreme Court, urging it to modify its order to shift jailed former premier Imran Khan to a private hospital for treatment.

The apex court on Tuesday directed that 73-year-old Pakistan Tehreek-e-Insaf founder be taken to Shifa International Hospital in Islamabad "within the next two days", and he shall remain there until the next hearing on September 16.



Russian President Vladimir Putin lights a candle near the relics of the Holy Grand Prince Dmitry Donskoy, in Moscow, on Thursday

AP/PTI

Briefs

Pakistan's NA passes two bills

ISLAMABAD: Pakistan's National Assembly on Thursday passed two bills related to the military and nuclear command structure to streamline changes in the military hierarchy in the wake of last year's 27th constitutional amendment.

The amendment introduced the office of Chief of Defence Forces by abolishing the office of the Chairman Joint Chiefs of Staff Committee.

Taliban releases two UN staffers

KABUL: Afghanistan's Taliban rulers have released two United Nations staff members whom they detained more than a week ago, the UN said Thursday, adding that the reason for the two men's detention remains unclear.

The arrests were the latest in a series of detentions by Afghanistan's Taliban authorities. Afghan authorities did not immediately comment on the UN staff members' release.

Pilot killed in plane crash in US

WASHINGTON: An airplane pilot died Wednesday after a violent collision with a Pennsylvania State Police helicopter near a runway at a small airport, but both state troopers aboard the helicopter survived, authorities said.

The plane was coming down on the runway and veered into the helicopter.

Boat capsizes in Nigeria

SOKOTO: A boat capsized Thursday in a river in Nigeria's northwestern Sokoto state, leaving more than 40 people dead, officials and residents said.

The boat was carrying people who were heading to farms for work in Gorau town in the Goronyo local government area of the state.

Samaila Garba, 55, said his 13-year-old granddaughter, Jamila Usman, was among those who died in the capsizing.

EXPLOSIONS BOOMED ACROSS THE CITY IN THE DARK

Russian missiles, drone barrage kill at least 16 in Ukraine's Kyiv

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Kyiv, August 20

Russia pounded the Ukrainian capital of Kyiv and the surrounding region with scores of missiles and drones in a nighttime aerial attack that lasted for hours and killed at least 16 people, officials said Thursday.

Moscow's forces have in recent months intensified their ballistic missile attacks on Kyiv, exploiting Ukraine's chronic shortage of US-made Patriot air defense interceptors, the sole weapon in its arsenal able to shoot down the missiles.

Large-scale Russian missile strikes have become a regular occurrence this summer. Just over two weeks ago, a Russian attack on Kyiv and its surrounding region killed 17 people, and nine were killed in the city two days before that. The United Nations said last week that Kyiv was one of the hardest hit cities in July, with at least 54 civilians killed and 202 injured.

At the same time, Ukraine has shifted the war onto Russian soil through long-range drone strikes on oil facilities that have caused fuel shortages across the country. It has also unsettled the Russian



A worker washes the landmark monument to Bohdan Khmelnytsky, who was a 17th-century leader of ancient Ukrainian Cossacks and national symbol, in Kyiv on wThursday

AP/PTI

HIGHLIGHTS

- » Moscow's forces have in recent months intensified their ballistic missile attacks on Kyiv
- » About 40 people were wounded, says President Zelenskyy

public by striking warehouses of Wildberries, the country's biggest online retailer.

President Volodymyr Zelenskyy has pleaded for countries to send more

Patriot interceptors for defence, but international stockpiles are low amid the Iran war and Kyiv's more than four-year fight against Russia's all-out invasion.

Russia's overnight bar-

rage also included cruise missiles and jet-powered drones that further strain air defences, Ukraine's air force said.

Explosions boomed across Kyiv in the dark, but the air force said hits were recorded at 28 locations across the country. Emergency services said 15 people were killed in the capital, with another death in the wider Kyiv region. About 40 people were wounded, Zelenskyy said,

Russia, Ukraine swap 103 prisoners of war each

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Kyiv, August 20

Russia and Ukraine have exchanged 103 prisoners of war each, officials from both sides said on Wednesday, with Ukrainian intelligence saying another swap was expected before the end of the month.

Kyiv and Moscow have carried out regular POW exchanges throughout the war that started with Russia's invasion of its smaller neighbour in 2022, while remaining far apart on terms for any peace deal.

President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said on Telegram the Ukrainians brought home included servicemen from the Armed Forces, the State Border Guard Service, and the National Guard.

as air raid warnings lasted until after dawn.

BNP's Mirza Fakhrul Islam Alamgir elected as B'desh's new Prez

Alamgir secured 255 votes while Oli Ahmad bagged 88 votes



Mirza Fakhrul Islam Alamgir

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Dhaka, August 20

Mirza Fakhrul Islam Alamgir, a longtime secretary general of the ruling Bangladesh Nationalist Party (BNP) and a close ally of former premier Khaleda Zia, was on Thursday elected as the country's new President in the first contested poll for the post in 35 years.

The 78-year-old BNP stalwart defeated his lone rival Colonel (ret'd) Oli Ahmed, the 84-year-old Liberal Democratic Party chairman and the nominee of the Jamaat-e-Islami-led 11-party opposition alliance, Chief Election Commissioner and also Election Returning Officer AMM Nasir Uddin announced after the

THE 78-YEAR-OLD BNP STALWART DEFEATED HIS LONE RIVAL COLONEL (RETD) OLI AHMED, THE 84-YEAR-OLD LIBERAL DEMOCRATIC PARTY CHAIRMAN

counting of votes.

Of the total 349 registered voters, 343 voted in the election.

Six lawmakers didn't vote, he said. Alamgir secured 255 votes while Oli Ahmad bagged 88 votes.

He will take the oath as Bangladesh's 23rd President on Friday evening at the Darbar Hall of Bangabhaban.

Iran dismisses US economic threats

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Dubai, August 20

Iran on Thursday dismissed US President Donald Trump's threats of economic pain and isolation, while the UK and other nations condemned Israel over a controversial settlement project.

Meanwhile, Syria's foreign minister visited Pakistan, which is seeking to defuse tensions between the United States and Iran.

Iran's Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi has rejected the economic



Iran's Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi

threats made against his country, saying that such "failed policies" will stir more hostility among Ira-

nians and "bring more failures."

Araghchi's comments came a few hours after President Donald Trump threatened "crushing economic measures" against Iran.

Trump promised "Economic Warfare and Isolation on an unprecedented scale," but provided few details.

In a social media post, Araghchi maintained the threats aim to divert the attention of the US public from domestic financial problems, adding that the

US "economic terrorism threatens the global economy and the national sovereignty of countries around the world."

Several countries condemned the latest development in a contentious Israeli settlement project near Jerusalem that would effectively cut the occupied West Bank in two.

Israel's Ministry of Construction and Housing issued a tender for constructing several compounds, with more than 1,200 homes in total in an open tract of land east of Jerusalem.

US aircraft carrier arrives in Middle East

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Washington, August 20

The USS George Washington aircraft carrier is now operating in the Middle East, the US military said Thursday.

US Central Command, which oversees military operations in the Middle East, said on social media that the carrier arrived in the region Wednesday.

US and others turn to Brazil for rare earths

Move raises environmental concerns



ASSOCIATED PRESS
Sao Paulo, August 20

In the global race to secure rare earths that are key for everything from mobile phones to green technologies, Brazil is emerging as an alternative to China's dominance, particularly for the United States and Australia, according to an analysis of mining permits by The Associated Press and Reporter Brasil.

That could boost the economy of Latin Amer-

KEY POINTS

- » Brazil is emerging as an alternative to China's dominance
- » Rare earths are essential in digital and defence technologies, not to 'torpedo the nascent progress'

ica's largest and most populous nation, which is second only to China in rare earth reserves.

Foreign capital is rushing in. Nearly half of the 2,727 overall rare earth exploration applications -- or 42 per cent -- in Brazil were made by

subsidiaries of foreign mining companies or firms with foreign ownership stakes. Eleven of the 20 companies with the largest number of applications are backed by foreign investment, mostly from Australia, the US and Canada.

Over 100 killed in gold mine collapse in CAR

Rescuers recover several bodies

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Bangui, August 20

A landslide at an illegal gold mine has killed more than 100 people in the Central African Republic.

Rescuers continued recovering bodies from the artisanal mining site in Zamboye, near the border with Cameroon, but local workers said that the response lacked the equipment and expertise needed for a disaster of this scale.

Artisanal mine collapses are common in Central African Republic, where thousands of people work in small-scale mining, often with little protection.

"Safety conditions are not ensured at these sites," said Chekoua Justin Landry, a programme manager with Forests and Rural Development, a Cameroonian nonprofit group that works on natural-resource governance and rural communities.

THE COUNTRY BECOMES INDIA'S FOURTH-LARGEST SUPPLIER

Indian crude oil imports from Venezuela rise sharply in August

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 20

India is widening its crude oil sourcing to Latin America as disruptions linked to the Iran conflict and the Strait of Hormuz push the world's third-largest oil consumer to diversify supplies, ship tracking data showed. Indian crude imports from Venezuela have risen sharply in August, making the South American country the fourth-largest supplier of India, according to Kpler's ship-tracking data. Venezuelan supplies reached about 444,000 bpd, ahead of Iraq's 118,000 bpd & the US' 153,000 bpd, the data showed. Venezuela's position in India's supply mix has risen rapidly since imports resumed in April. Indian refiners hiked purchases of Venezuelan, Brazilian and African crude after disruptions to Middle Eastern supplies, while continuing to rely heavily on Russian oil. Russia remains the dominant supplier, with imports close to 2 million bpd in



August. Russian crude imports reached around 2.6 million bpd in June-July, accounting for more than half of India's crude intake and effectively providing a hedge against disruption to traditional Middle Eastern supply routes. "India's strategy is increasingly operating on several fronts at once: increasing domestic upstream production where possible, diversifying overseas crude suppliers and transportation routes, building strategic and commercial inventories, and accelerating alternatives

such as gas, biofuels, EVs and renewables," said Sumit Ritolia, Senior Manager - Modelling at Kpler. The shift highlights a broader strategy emerging from the disruption: India is not moving away from oil in the near term, but is seeking to make the crude it still needs more secure and resilient by widening its supplier base and transportation options. That reflects a key feature of India's current energy-security strategy: replacing Middle Eastern barrels entirely is neither practical nor necessarily

KEY POINTS

» Venezuelan supplies reached about 444,000 barrels per day, ahead of Iraq's 118,000 bpd and the United States' 153,000 bpd, the Kpler data showed

» Russia remains the dominant supplier, with imports close to 2 million bpd in August. Russian crude imports reached around 2.6 million bpd in June-July

economical, Ritolia said. Gulf producers remain geographically closer to India, reducing voyage times and transportation costs compared with other sources such as Venezuela, the US, West Africa and Latin America. Indian refiners have nevertheless shown considerable flexibility in switching between Middle Eastern, Russian and Atlantic Basin barrels. Overall crude imports have remained around 5 million bpd in recent months, allowing refinery operations to remain relatively resilient despite the

disruption. Longer voyages from Venezuela, the US, West Africa or Latin America can increase freight and insurance costs, he said adding geopolitical disruption can therefore raise India's oil import bill. "Diversification helps with supply security, but it can only go so far in insulating India from geopolitics. India will still need to import large volumes of crude, meaning any major disruption will ultimately feed through into higher oil prices, freight and import costs," Ritolia said. Indian refiners dramatically hiked Russian purchases as the Iran conflict disrupted Gulf flows. Russian crude accounted for over half of India's imports in July, while supplies from the Middle East fell to about 30 per cent of the country's import basket during April-July, from 43 per cent a year earlier. Latin American supplies, including Venezuela & Brazil, rose to 12.7 per cent over the same period from 3.5 per cent.

Retail inflation may cross 6% in Oct-Nov before easing in Q4 FY27

The SBI Research report said improving food supply conditions could help contain inflation

ANI NEWS
New Delhi, August 20

India's retail inflation could briefly cross 6 per cent in October-November before easing to around 5 per cent in Q4 FY27, according to an SBI Research report. The report expects retail inflation to rise to 4.7 per cent in August from 4.45 per cent in July. "We expect August inflation print at 4.7 per cent, with inflation possibly just breaching the 6 per cent in October-November before declining to 5 per cent in Q4 FY27," it said. The report said improving food supply conditions could help contain inflation. The monsoon has recovered after a weak start, with surplus rainfall in July and normal rainfall in August narrowing the overall rainfall deficit to around 13 per cent from nearly 40 per cent in June. It also said a positive Indian Ocean Dipole (IOD) could partly offset the impact of El Nino. Kharif sowing is only 2 per cent below last season despite below-normal rainfall in



THE REPORT EXPECTS RETAIL INFLATION TO RISE TO 4.7 PER CENT IN AUGUST FROM 4.45 PER CENT IN JULY

some major foodgrain-producing states, "indicating better irrigation facilities among states." The SBI report said historical trends also suggest that Q4 inflation could be lower than current forecasts. On monetary policy, RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra has indicated that the RBI would need greater clarity on the inflation trajectory before recalibrating the policy rate. According to the minutes of the latest Monetary Policy Committee meeting, Malhotra said inflation was

showing signs of normalisation from earlier benign levels and preferred to wait for more evidence before deciding the future course of monetary policy. The SBI report flagged concerns over central bank communication, saying recent policy actions could carry greater weight than forward guidance. Referring to measures such as variable rate reverse repo operations (VRRR) and the FCNR(B) deposit mobilisation window, it said: "markets must ensure a premium to pragmatic action vis-a-vis honest communication." On global markets, the report said US Federal Reserve measures aimed at smoothing the long end of the US Treasury yield curve, including increased government debt repurchases, could have implications for global markets. It noted that yields have declined across longer maturities and the benchmark 10-year segment amid expectations of a shift in government debt supply between short- and long-term maturities.

SBI revises free withdrawal rules for BSBD accounts

AGENCIES
New Delhi, August 20

State Bank of India (SBI) will revise its free cash withdrawal rules for Basic Savings Bank Deposit (BSBD) accounts from October 1, 2026. BSBD account holders will continue to get four free cash withdrawals every month. However, digital cash withdrawals will now be included in the same four-transaction limit. Withdrawals beyond the fourth will attract a charge of Rs 15 plus GST each. Currently, digital withdrawals are not counted towards the monthly limit, with only cash withdrawals through branches and ATMs considered. Under the revised rules, two ATM withdrawals and two digital cash withdrawals, for instance, would exhaust the four free transactions. The fifth withdrawal, irrespective of the channel, would be chargeable. The change applies to the branch channel of BSBD accounts under Product Code 1011-1701. Non-financial transactions and fund transfers will remain unaffected. BSBD accounts are designed to provide basic banking services without a minimum balance requirement.

Nine key infra sectors' output growth rises by 5.4% in July

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, August 20

Output growth of nine key infrastructure sectors rose to 5.4 per cent in July following an increase in output of coal, refinery products, cement, electricity and iron ore. However, the growth rate was slower than in June, when these sectors expanded by 6 per cent. The core sectors' growth was 3.2 per cent in July 2025. From June, the data has been released with a

new base year, 2022-23. The government has added iron ore to the index, increasing the number of core sectors to nine. According to the official data released on Thursday, production of crude oil, natural gas, and fertiliser declined during the month. The rate of growth in steel output slowed down to 2.9 per cent in July as against 15.7 per cent in the same month last year. During April-July 2026-27, the key sectors expanded by 4.3 per cent against 1.5 per

cent in the same period last year. Commenting on the data, Devendra Pant, Chief Economist, Ind-Ra, said that fertilizers, crude oil & natural gas that account for 14 per cent of the core industries' output, continued to contract, though natural gas contraction was slower than the preceding month. While, iron ore, electricity and steel that account for 53.4 per cent of the index recorded slower growth compared to a month earlier.

NSE may allow its shares to trade on its platform

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, August 20

The National Stock Exchange (NSE) may allow its shares to trade on its platform after being listed on a rival bourse, without requiring a separate approval from Sebi, as the proposed arrangement would fall under the exchange's existing 'permitted-to-trade' framework, an industry source said on Thursday. The distinction is important as permitted-to-trade is not the same as listing. While a listed company has dis-

closure and compliance obligations towards the primary exchange where it is listed, the 'permitted-to-trade' framework only helps investors to buy and sell the security on another bourse. Under the permitted-to-trade framework, an exchange can allow trading in shares that are listed on another recognised stock exchange. The company does not become listed on the exchange where its shares are permitted to trade. "NSE may not be required to take Sebi approval for allowing its

own shares to trade on the platform as far as it lists its shares on another exchange," the source familiar with the development said. NSE already has more than 200 companies whose shares trade on its platform but are not listed on its platform, suggesting that trading on an exchange does not necessarily mean that the security is listed there. The same mechanism is being used by other exchanges. MSEI and NCDEX together have around 4,000 companies whose securities are permitted to trade on

their platforms even though they are not listed on those exchanges. Such permitted-to-trade arrangements do not involve a separate approval from Sebi for each security, as the process concerns trading of securities and does not amount to a fresh listing. The move could become significant for NSE as it prepares for its own public-market debut. If NSE lists its shares on another exchange, the shares could potentially subsequently be permitted to trade on NSE under the existing framework.

Share of institutional investors' in Nifty 50 falls to record low of 56.1% in 1st qtr of FY27

The NSE Market Pulse report said institutional investors have increasingly shifted towards mid- and small-cap stocks

AGENCIES
Mumbai, August 20

The share of institutional investors in Nifty 50 stocks fell to a record low of 56.1 per cent in Q1 FY27, declining 3.1 percentage points from the previous quarter, according to the NSE Market Pulse report for August. Institutional allocation to Nifty 50 stocks has fallen 4.8 percentage points in the first half of 2026 and is now 16.3 percentage points below the pre-pandemic peak of



72.4 per cent recorded in December 2019. The NSE said institutional investors have increasingly shifted towards mid- and small-cap stocks. Individual investors also reduced their allocation to Nifty 50 stocks by 3.1 percentage points to a record

low of 33.4 per cent during the quarter. Domestic mutual funds cut their allocation to the largest group of stocks by 4.3 percentage points to 83.5 per cent, while foreign portfolio investors (FPIs) reduced their allocation by around 3 percentage points to a six-year low of 89 per cent. The report said the shift reflects renewed interest in mid-cap, small-cap and micro-cap stocks. It also highlighted a broader trend of institutional investors

spreading their investments across a larger number of listed companies. FPI ownership expanded from around 1,200 NSE-listed companies in December 2020 to over 2,000 currently, despite a temporary decline to around 1,450 companies in Q4 FY23. However, the wider FPI coverage has been accompanied by greater selectivity in holding sizes, with larger stakes remaining concentrated in a relatively smaller portion of their portfolios.

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Mumbai, August 20

Domestic air passenger traffic slipped 4.80 per cent to 1.20 crore in July from 1.26 crore recorded in the year-ago month, with all major Indian airlines seeing a drop in the load factor, data released on Thursday by DGCA showed. Passengers carried by domestic airlines during January-July 2026 increased to 984.03 lakh against 977.79 lakh a year ago, thereby registering an annual growth of 0.64 per cent, according to the DGCA. IndiGo carried 80.82

lakh passengers during the previous month against 89.20 lakh in June; Air India group flew 28.75 lakh passengers during the reporting period compared to 32.22 lakh in June 2026, DGCA data showed. The total number of passengers transported by Akasa Air stood at 6.65 lakh in July against 8.61 lakh in June. Passenger volumes at SpiceJet were seen at 1.87 lakh in the previous month against 2.63 lakh passengers in June, it said. IndiGo raised its market share in the previous month to 67.4 per cent from 66.3 per cent, and Air India group market share also

rose marginally to 24 per cent from 23.9 per cent in June. Akasa and SpiceJet saw their market share falling to 5.5 per cent (from 6.4 per cent) and 1.6 per cent (from 1.9 per cent) in June, according to data. In on-time performance, IndiGo had the highest percentage of its flights (91.2 per cent) departing and arriving on time, followed by Akasa Air (90.8 per cent) to and from 10 domestic airports – Bengaluru, Delhi, Hyderabad, Mumbai, Chennai, Kolkata, Ahmedabad, Cochin, Guwahati and Lucknow – during the previous month, according to the aviation safety regulator.

Small UCBs face risks bigger than their size due to cyber threats: RBI Dy Guv Swaminathan said the growing use of technology in banking has changed the nature of risks faced by smaller banks

ANI NEWS
Hyderabad, August 20

Urban co-operative banks (UCBs) may be smaller in size, but technology, cyber threats and dependence on external service providers are exposing them to risks that can be much larger than their physical or geographical presence, RBI Deputy Governor Swaminathan J said. Speaking at the Mission SAKSHAM programme for Directors, Managing Direc-

tors and CEOs of UCBs in Telangana, Swaminathan said the growing use of technology in banking has changed the nature of risks faced by smaller banks. "While the size of a UCB may be limited, the risks it faces may originate far beyond its physical or geographical boundaries. The institution may be small, but the risk environment around it can be much larger," he said. Swaminathan also stressed that cyber attack-

ers do not distinguish between large and small banks. "A cyber attacker does not distinguish between a large bank and a small bank. A digital fraud does not slow down because the bank has fewer branches," he said. He said customers today expect banking services to be available quickly and conveniently through digital channels, including fund transfers, payments and access to accounts. Meeting

CLOSER LOOK

» The Deputy Governor pointed out that many UCBs depend on outside service providers for critical functions such as Core Banking Solutions, payment applications and data centres

» While outsourcing allows smaller banks to access technology and expertise that could otherwise be difficult or expensive to build themselves, it also creates additional risks, he said

these expectations requires UCBs to strengthen their technology and digital capabilities. However, smaller UCBs may not have the same resources and spe-

cialised manpower available to larger commercial banks to deal with complex cyber threats, digital fraud and technology failures. The Deputy Governor

pointed out that many UCBs depend on outside service providers for critical functions such as Core Banking Solutions, payment applications and data centres. While outsourcing allows smaller banks to access technology and expertise that could otherwise be difficult or expensive to build themselves, it also creates additional risks, he said. This raises an important question for bank boards and CEOs, according to

Swaminathan: "How much of my bank today actually sits outside my bank?" He said banks need to understand which systems are operated by external providers and what would happen if a service provider becomes unavailable for a few hours or even a day. "The service provider may operate the system, but responsibility for understanding the risks, putting appropriate safeguards in place and ensuring continuity of critical

services continues to rest with the bank," he said. He said smaller UCBs cannot be expected to build every specialised capability internally. Instead, common infrastructure, shared expertise and sector-level arrangements could help them manage their technology and operational challenges. He also highlighted Mission SAKSHAM, a Reserve Bank initiative launched on April 28 this year to build capabilities across the UCB sector.

News at a glance

Gold rises to three-month high of ₹1.62 lakh/10 grams

NEW DELHI: Gold staged a sharp comeback in the national capital on Thursday, rising by Rs 4,300 to a three-month high of Rs 1,62,300/10 grams as investors turned to precious metals amid a weak US dollar. Silver mirrored the rally, soaring to a seven-week high of Rs 2,45,000/kg from Rs 2,35,000/kg.

The rally in spot bullion prices came despite a retreat in the overseas markets. Gold dipped \$66.31, or 1.47 per cent, to \$4,456.72 per ounce, and silver dropped nearly 2 per cent to \$65.82 per ounce.

Tata-owned IHCL launches Taj Palace hotel in Lucknow

NEW DELHI: Tata Group-owned Indian Hotels Company (IHCL) has opened the 181-key Taj Palace hotel in Lucknow, its second Taj property in the city. Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath inaugurated the hotel on Wednesday.

IHCL MD and CEO Puneet Chhatwal said the opening reflects Lucknow's growing importance as an economic and tourism centre and the company's commitment to Uttar Pradesh.

IHCL has a portfolio of 60 hotels across more than 20 cities in the state.

DPIIT inks MoU with Shell, PhonePe to support startups

NEW DELHI: The DPIIT on Thursday signed partnerships with PhonePe and Shell India to support startups through technology, digital infrastructure, mentorship and market access.

Under the PhonePe pact, DPIIT-recognised startups will get payment gateway transaction credits, Indus AppStore access, onboarding support and brand visibility. Shell India will support energy and climate-tech startups through mentorship, strategic guidance, investor connections and participation in its E4 Smart Energy Track.

Prudential Health Insurance India commences operations

NEW DELHI: Prudential HCL Health Insurance, backed by Prudential plc and the HCL Group, on Thursday announced commencement of operations in India. The company received its Certificate of Registration on July 1, 2026.

Entering India's health insurance market, it aims to offer customer-focused, AI-powered solutions. The insurer provides access to over 12,000 hospitals and will operate through an omnichannel model combining an agency network with an AI-enabled direct-to-consumer platform.

INVESTORS' WEALTH SURGES TO Rs 4,91,41,686.64 CRORE

Markets rebound as Sensex jumps 628 pts, Nifty snaps 7-day losing run

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, August 20

Benchmark equity indices bounced back on Thursday, with the Sensex climbing 628 points and the Nifty snapping its seven-day losing streak as easing global bond yields fueled a stock rally worldwide.

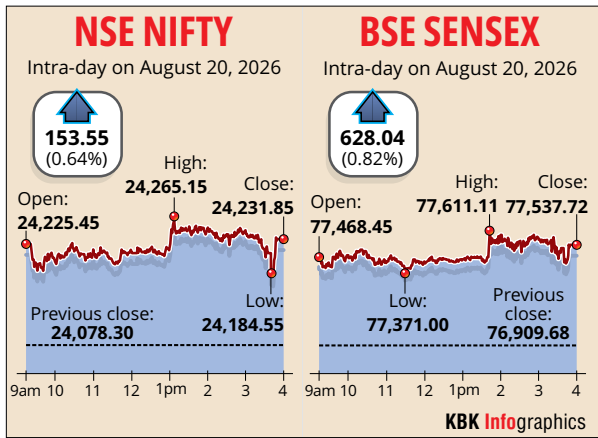
The 30-share BSE Sensex jumped 628.04 points, or 0.82 per cent, to settle at 77,537.72 after four days of decline. During the day, it surged 701.43 points, or 0.91 per cent, to 77,611.11.

Snapping its seven-day falling streak, the 50-share NSE Nifty rose by 153.55 points, or 0.64 per cent, to close at 24,231.85.

Among the Sensex firms, Eternal, Kotak Mahindra Bank, ITC, Bajaj Finance, Axis Bank and UltraTech Cement were the biggest winners.

Tata Steel, InterGlobe Aviation, HCL Tech and Titan were the laggards.

"Indian equity markets ended higher on Thursday, snapping a seven-session losing streak—the longest in nearly 11 months—as



FOREIGN INSTITUTIONAL INVESTORS (FIIS) BOUGHT EQUITIES WORTH RS 407.99 CRORE ON WEDNESDAY, ACCORDING TO EXCHANGE DATA

easing global bond yields revived risk appetite and encouraged investors back into equities.

"The recovery marked a decisive shift from the cautious tone that had dominated recent sessions, with benchmark indices holding on to their early gains throughout the day," Hariselman Radhakrishnan, Founder & CEO of HST Wealth, a SEBI-registered Research Analyst

firm, said.

Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) bought equities worth Rs 407.99 crore on Wednesday, according to exchange data.

The BSE SmallCap Select index climbed 0.83 per cent and MidCap Select index was up 0.56 per cent.

Among sectoral indices, Realty jumped the most by 1.87 per cent. FMCG

KEY POINTS

» Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) bought equities worth Rs 407.99 crore on Wednesday, according to exchange data

» The BSE SmallCap Select index climbed 0.83 per cent and MidCap Select index was up 0.56 per cent

» Among sectoral indices, Realty jumped most by 1.87 per cent, followed by FMCG (1.03 per cent), Focused IT (1.02 per cent), IT (0.94 per cent), Financial Services (0.85 per cent), Consumer Discretionary (0.75 per cent) and Top 10 Banks (0.69 per cent) also advanced

(1.03 per cent), Focused IT (1.02 per cent), IT (0.94 per cent), Financial Services (0.85 per cent), Consumer Discretionary (0.75 per cent) and Top 10 Banks (0.69 per cent) also advanced.

Hospitals emerged as the only laggard.

"Indian equity markets rebounded on Wednesday, snapping a seven-session losing streak as easing pressure in global bond mar-

kets and resilient domestic buying outweighed persistent geopolitical concerns," Ponmudi R, CEO of Enrich Money, an online trading and wealth tech firm, said.

The US Treasury's expanded bond-buyback programme, aimed at easing upward pressure on long-term borrowing costs, helped stabilise global bond markets and improve near-term risk sentiment, supporting gains across Asian equities and lifting domestic financial and information technology stocks, he added.

Investors' wealth surged by Rs 2.71 lakh crore to Rs 4,91,41,686.64 crore (\$5.14 trillion).

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, jumped 2.67 per cent to \$93.91 per barrel.

On Wednesday, the Sensex was down 325.78 points, or 0.42 per cent, to settle at 76,909.68, registering its fourth day of decline.

Extending its losses to the seventh day, the Nifty declined 76.60 points, or 0.32 per cent, to end at 24,078.30.

Sebi eases FPI onboarding with digitally signed Power of Attorney

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 20

Capital markets regulator Sebi on Thursday eased the onboarding process for foreign portfolio investors by allowing them to submit a digitally signed power of attorney to their custodians.

Under the revised rule, an FPI can give a Power of Attorney (PoA) to its custodian specifying its address and execute the document by using a digital signature in accordance with the provisions of the Information Technology Act, 2000, Sebi said.

A Power of Attorney is a document through which a foreign portfolio investor

(FPI) authorises its custodian to act on its behalf.

For an FPI, a custodian is a financial institution that safely holds and manages investors' securities and assets. They also act as designated depository participants to process FPI registrations, clear trades, manage settlements, and report compliance to regulators.

This eliminates the need for notarisation, apostillation or consularisation of the Power of Attorney, thereby reducing the overall time taken for FPI onboarding and improving ease of doing business for FPI applicants, it added.

The Securities and

Exchange Board of India (Sebi) said the move is part of its continued efforts to digitalise the FPI onboarding process.

Over the years, Sebi has introduced several measures in this direction, including a Common Application Form (CAF) for FPI registration, PAN, bank and demat accounts, permitting Indian digital signatures for executing CAF and other registration documents, digital signatures functionality within the CAF portal and granting registration based on scanned copies.

The provisions of this circular will come into force with effect from August 20, 2026, it said.

L&T-MHI consortium wins large Dubai Airport transit system order

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 20

Infrastructure major L&T on Thursday said its transportation infrastructure vertical, in consortium with Japan's Mitsubishi Heavy Industries (MHI), has secured a 'large' order to design and build a fully driverless, grade-separated mass transit system for Phase I of Al Maktoum International Airport in Dubai.

According to the company, the valuation of a large order ranges between Rs 2,500 crore and Rs 5,000 crore.

In a regulatory filing, L&T said, "The transportation infrastructure business vertical of L&T, in consortium with Japan's Mitsubishi Heavy Industries (MHI), has secured a large order

an opportunity. Invest in critical minerals, in API (Application Programming Interface) manufacturing, in domestic electronic components. Every supply chain we secure is a choke point we neutralise. Fourth, diversify markets actively," Singh said.

India's trade pacts with Oman, New Zealand, and Mauritius have opened corridors in the Gulf, Oceania, and East Africa that were earlier inaccessible on preferential terms.

"Fifth, engage on standards. The country that rides the technical standards owns the market. India must move from being a standard taker to a standard setter. UPI, ONDC, and BharatNet are early signals of what sovereign standards can achieve," he said adding now industry must build the scale.

Let us not be China plus one. Let us be India, the trusted partner, the resilient manufacturer, and the next great engine of global growth". Talking about global uncertainties, he said restrictions on critical minerals are being weaponised, technology choke points are being deliberately engineered and trade is no longer just an economic instrument.

Briefs

Rupee falls 1 paisa to 95.74/dollar

MUMBAI: The rupee pared initial gains and settled for the day down 1 paisa at 95.74 against the US dollar on Thursday, as the support from the weaker dollar index was negated by elevated crude oil prices.

At the interbank foreign exchange, the rupee opened at 95.57 against the greenback and traded in a range of 95.56-95.74 during the session. It eventually settled at 95.74, down 1 paisa from its previous close.

Aditya Birla Group enters gold loan biz

MUMBAI: Aditya Birla Capital on Thursday announced plans to enter the gold loan business, targeting 1,000 branches over three years.

The NBFC will open up to 300 branches by the end of FY27 across high-potential markets.

The move comes amid a surge in gold-backed lending, with NBFC gold jewellery loans rising 69.3 per cent year-on-year to Rs 3.42 lakh crore in June 2026.

IRDAI bars Niva Bupa Health from opening new office for 6 months

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 20

Insurance regulator IRDAI has directed Niva Bupa Health Insurance not to open any new place of business for six months for violating Expense of Management (EoM) limits for FY25, the insurer said on Thursday.

The Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI) issued the order on August 19, warning the company for non-compliance with the applicable EoM limits.

EoM covers the operational expenses incurred

by insurers to conduct business and service policyholders.

Niva Bupa said it complied with the IRDAI (Expenses of Management, including Commission of Insurers) Regulations, 2024 during FY26 and the April-June quarter of 2026. It added that it remains on track to comply with the regulations in the ongoing financial year.

The insurer said it is evaluating the order and will take appropriate steps to safeguard stakeholders' interests.

Shares of Niva Bupa closed 1.70 per cent lower at Rs 82.61 on the BSE.

Fisheries Secy reviews Tilapia cluster in Raipur

India's seafood exports stood at ₹73,890.46 cr despite trade disruptions

MPOST BUREAU
Raipur, August 21

Dr Abhilaksh Likhi, Secretary, Department of Fisheries, Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry and Dairying, on Thursday chaired an interactive meeting in Raipur to review the progress of the Tilapia Cluster notified under the Pradhan Mantri Matsya Sampada Yojana (PMMSY).

The meeting brought together over 1,300 Tilapia farmers and value-chain stakeholders, along



with officials, scientists, exporters and representatives from NFDB, MPEDA and NABARD. Discussions focused on strengthening

production, processing, value addition and exports.

Likhi said India's fish production has reached a record 198 lakh tonnes,

while seafood exports stood at Rs 73,890.46 crore despite global trade disruptions. Nearly Rs 900 crore has been invested under PMMSY in Chhattisgarh, helping double the state's fish production to nearly 10 lakh tonnes.

He urged greater collaboration among farmers, the state government, research institutions and exporters to address value-chain gaps and prepare an export roadmap. He also asked MPEDA to expand its presence in the state.

Later, Likhi visited MM Hatcheries in Raipur, which produces genetically improved Tilapia seed. The hatchery has received Rs 5 crore under the PMMSY Entrepreneurship Model and Rs 35 lakh under PM-MKSSY. Chhattisgarh has exported 382 tonnes of Tilapia to the US. Stakeholders sought a Common Facility Centre, easier credit, quality seed, lower input costs and stronger market linkages to improve farmer incomes and export competitiveness.

CORPORATE KALEIDOSCOPE

Dr Neeraj Mittal, Secretary, Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas, along with CMDs of oil and gas companies and bp India Chairman Kartikeya Dube, launched MC2+ Ignite at IIT Madras on August 19.

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

E-Tender Notice

E-tenders are invited by Chief Workshop Manager, Rail Coach Naveenikaran Karkhana, Jhansi from experienced and interested contractors on behalf of the President of India for the under mentioned work-

Open Tender No. : JHS-RCNK-M-AG-26-27-22

Name of Work : Anti-graffiti Coating in Coaches.

Cost of work. : Rs. 4,07,97,770.00/- (Including 18% GST)

Earnest Money Deposit/Bid Security : Rs. 8,16,000.00/- Time of completion : Thirty-Six Months

Online Tender Closing Date and Time : 14.09.2026 at 11:00 Hrs.

Detailed information about tender and tender format is available at website www.irops.gov.in

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in CPRONC

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

L. No. JHS-DyCEE-WS-T-02-2026-27

Date : 18.08.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

For and on behalf of President of India, the Dy.CEE/WS/JHS, North Central Railway, Jhansi invites open tenders through online (E-Tendering) for the following work:-

Tender No.: JHS-DyCEE/WS-T-02-2026-27

Description of work : Jhansi Workshop:- Reconditioning and repairing of 07 nos. EOT (05 to 10 Ton Capacity) cranes and provision of shrouded type copper bus bar in place of MS angle iron DSL in 5 bays of Wagon repair workshop Jhansi.

Tender value : Rs. 9505021/- (Ninety Five Lakhs Five Thousand Twenty one Only)

Bid Security : Rs. 190100/- (One Lakhs Ninety Thousand one Hundred only)

Completion period : 06 months

Closing date of tender : 14.09.2026 (upto 15:00 Hrs.).

Tenderer will submit the tender online upto **14.09.2026 (upto 15:00 Hrs.)**. Complete details & for submission of tenders can be seen in Indian Railway website www.irops.gov.in 1917/26 (AS)

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in CPRONC

APPENDIX IV-A

Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Property

E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s) that the below described Immovable Property mortgaged to Sammaan Finserve Limited (formerly known as Indiabulls Commercial Credit Limited) [CIN : U65923DL2006PLC150632] ("Secured Creditor"), the constructive possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of the Secured Creditor, will be sold on "as is where is", "as is what is" and "whatever there is" basis on 25.09.2026 from 05.00 P.M. to 06.00 P.M., for recovery of Rs. 1,44,60,182/- (Rupees One Crore Forty Four Lakh Sixty Thousand One Hundred Eighty Two Only) pending towards Loan Account No. HLLAPAN00538076, by way of outstanding principal, arrears (including accrued late charges) and interest till 18.08.2026 with applicable future interest in terms of the Loan Agreement and other related loan document(s) w. e. f. 19.08.2026 along with legal expenses and other charges due to the Secured Creditor from PARVEEN (PROPRIETOR, M/s MALIK DEFENCE ACADEMY) and SATYANTI.

The Reserve Price of the Immovable Property will be Rs. 1,86,00,000/- (Rupees One Crore Eighty Six Lakh only) and the Earned Money Deposit ("EMD") will be Rs. 18,60,000/- (Rupees Eighteen Lakh Sixty Thousand only) i.e. equivalent to 10% of the Reserve Price.

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY

ALL THAT PART AND PARCEL OF THE PROPERTY BEING PLOT NO. 6, MEASURING AREA OF 210 SQ. YARDS, BEARING PROPERTY ID NO. 156C80U279, WARD NO. 06, IN PART OF KHEWAT NO. 1463, KHATA NO. 1653, RECTT. AND KILLA NO. 7216/1 (5-16), 25/2(5-16) 73/20(8-9) 21(8-0), 22/1(3-16), MOUJA PADA, IN BASANT VIHAR, GALI NO. 1, ROHTAK - 124001, HARYANA, ADMEASURING 210 SQ. YARD.

BOUNDED AS UNDER:

EAST :	PLOT NO. 15	NORTH :	NORTH PLOT NO. 7
WEST :	RASTA	SOUTH :	PLOT NO. 5

For detailed terms and conditions of the sale, please refer to the link provided on the website of the Secured Creditor i.e. www.sammaanfinservelimited.com. Contact No: 0124-6910910, +91 7065451024, E-mail id: auctionhelpline@sammaancapital.com. For bidding, log on to www.auctionfocus.in.

SD/-

AUTHORISED OFFICER

SAMMAAN FINSERVE LIMITED (Formerly known as INDIABULLS COMMERCIAL CREDIT LIMITED)

Date : 18.08.2026

Place : ROHTAK

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

Tender Notice No: 6720262027

Dated: 18.08.2026

E-TENDERING TENDER NOTICE

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering)/North Central Railway/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites the following E-Tender on prescribed form for the following works upto 13:30 hrs, on 10.09.2026. The details of the tenders are as under:-

S.No.: 1	Tender No.: 146
Name of Works: (a) Augmentation of classrooms & Hostel at CETA Kanpur under ADEN/HQ/II/CNB. (b) Upgradation of CETA's school classroom facilities and CCTV for school campus and CETA's hostel under ADEN/HQ/II/CNB.	
Approx. Cost of Work (Rs.): ₹ 2,65,89,526.76	Completion Period: 08 Months
Earnest Money (Rs.) ₹ 5,31,800.00	Date of Opening of Tender: 10.09.2026
Similar work for Eligibility Criteria: Construction of Building.	
S.No.: 2	Tender No.: 147
Name of Works: (a) Panki Dham- Prayagraj Division-Improvement/upgradation of P-F-2/3 at PNKD STN under ADEN/Line/CNB. (b) Provision of Rain Water Harvesting at Juhl, CNB, PNKD & RRR from Environment Cess Fund under ADEN/Line/CNB.	
Approx. Cost of Work (Rs.): ₹ 2,64,54,878.70	Completion Period: 06 Months
Earnest Money (Rs.) ₹ 5,29,100.00	Date of Opening of Tender: 10.09.2026
Similar work for Eligibility Criteria: Any Civil Engineering work	
Note: (1) Tender on line can be submitted up to 13:30 hrs, on 10.09.2026. (2) The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders are available on Website www.irops.gov.in up to 13:30 hrs, on the due date of tender opening i.e. 10.09.2026. 1914/26 (A)	
North central railways CPRONC www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in	

NORTHERN RAILWAY

(E-Auction Notice)

The Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/ G. Northern Railway, Delhi Division, New Delhi invites e-Auction through IREPS (<https://irops.gov.in/>) for allotment of contracts of General Minor Units (GMUs) for Catering Units at following railway stations/locations:

SN	Auction Catalogue No.	Date & Time for e-Auction	Railway Station	Lot No.	Type of Unit
1			Modinagar	Catg-DLI-MDNR-GMU-125-25-1	
2			Garhi Harsaru	Catg-DLI-GHH-GMU-99-25-1	
3			Mansa	Catg-DLI-MSZ-GMU-140-25-1	
4				Catg-DLI-MSZ-GMU-138-25-1	
5			Behta Hajipur	Catg-DLI-BHHZ-GMU-157-25-1	
6				Catg-DLI-BHHZ-GMU-90-25-1	
7			Khekra	Catg-DLI-KEX-GMU-105-25-1	
8			Ganaur	Catg-DLI-GNU-GMU-146-25-1	
9				Catg-DLI-GNU-GMU-133-25-1	
10			Khatauli	Catg-DLI-KAT-GMU-103-25-1	
11	CTG-AUG-01-26	07.09.2026 at 11:00 Hrs		Catg-DLI-KAT-GMU-129-25-1	General Minor Unit (GMU)
12			Mangolpuri	Catg-DLI-MGLP-GMU-108-25-1	
13			Julana	Catg-DLI-JNA-GMU-98-25-1	
14			Asaoti	Catg-DLI-AST-GMU-148-25-1	
15				Catg-DLI-AST-GMU-100-25-1	
16			Budhlada	Catg-DLI-BLZ-GMU-171-25-1	
17			Holambi Kalan	Catg-DLI-HUK-GMU-114-25-1	
18			Bareta	Catg-DLI-BRZ-GMU-88-25-1	
19			Fakharpur	Catg-DLI-FAP-GMU-95-25-1	
20			Maur	Catg-DLI-MAUR-GMU-151-25-1	
21			Gotra Halt	Catg-DLI-GTRA-GMU-158-25-1	
22			Gharaunda	Catg-DLI-GRA-GMU-97-25-1	

Website particulars where complete details of E-Auction can be seen <https://irops.gov.in/> (E-Auction-Leasing)

All contractors who intend to participate in the e-auctions conducted through E-Auction Leasing module of IREPS should fulfil following mandatory requirements before they can submit their bids:

- > Registration on IREPS for E-Auction Leasing module - Active IREPS User Account for E-Auction Leasing Module.
- > Payment of One Time Registration Fee; Current Account in State Bank of India; Integration of SBI Bank Account with IREPS Account; Lien Marking of Funds; Updation of Turnover Details.
- > A new mechanism namely Virtual Account Number (VAN) has been introduced now for E-Auction Leasing module, which can be used by the bidders as an alternative to Lien Marking Mechanism.
- > The bidders are free to switch between Lien Marking Mechanism (if activated) and VAN mechanism at any point of time, before entering the bidding room, VAN mechanism does not require the bidder to have a current account in State Bank of India. The users are free to transfer money from any of their existing bank accounts in any bank to their VAN account, which enables them to participate in IREPS E-Auctions.
- > Contractors who do not have IREPS account for any module of IREPS can submit their online request for registration by clicking on New Vendors / Contractors (E-Tender /E-Auction Leasing) link on IREPS Home page.

Railway Authority to contact, in case of any query	Divisional Railway Manager's Office, Commercial Branch, State Entry Road, New Delhi 110055, Email: catering.delhidivision@gmail.com, Tel: 011-23743084.
No. 23 AC/Ctg./e-Auction/GMU & SMU/2026 Dated: 19.08.2026	2892/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Ravinder Singh @ Ravi S/o Ram Chander, R/o Village-Gajendhar Patti, Bhaidovra, PS-Atroliya, Distt.-Ajamgarh (U.P.)**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 134/2006, U/S 420/467/471/120-B IPC, PS Kashmere Gate, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Ravinder Singh @ Ravi** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Ravinder Singh @ Ravi** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Ravinder Singh @ Ravi** the said accused of **FIR No. 134/2006, U/S 420/467/471/120-B IPC, PS Kashmere Gate, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.09.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Vaibhav Garg
Judicial Magistrate First Class-11,
Central Distt., Court No.-138, 1st Floor,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/11723/N/2026
(Court Matter)

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

Tender Notice No. 6520262027

Dated: 17.08.2026

E-TENDERING TENDER NOTICE

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering)/North Central Railway/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites the following E-tenders, for the following works up to 13:30 hrs, on 16.09.2026. The details of the works are as under :

SN.: 01, Tender No.: 140, Name of Works: Extension of Bridge No. 41, 42, 42A & 43 and other miscellaneous works under the section of Assistant Divisional Engineer/Line/Prayagraj.

Approx Cost of work (Rs.): 4,13,89,920.21 **Earnest Money (Rs.): 8,27,800.00**

Completion Period: 18 (Eighteen) Months, **Date of Opening of Tender: 16.09.2026, Minimum Eligibility Criteria for "Similar work":** Construction of any type of bridge.

SN.: 02, Tender No.: 141, Name of Works: Rehabilitation of Bridge No. 112 (Upline & Downline) by providing PSC slab and other miscellaneous works under the section of Assistant Divisional Engineer/Line/Prayagraj.

Approx Cost of work (Rs): 1,73,77,177.90 **Earnest Money (Rs): 3,47,600.00**

Completion Period: 12 (Twelve) Months **Date of Opening of Tender: 16.09.2026, Minimum Eligibility Criteria for "Similar work":** Any bridge work in running track or regirdering work in running track.

Note: 1. E-Tender Forms shall be issued free of cost to all tenderers. 2. The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders are available on Website www.irops.gov.in up to 13:30 hrs. on the due date of tender opening i.e. 16.09.2026. 3. Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificate issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. 4. Rates entered into Financial Rate page and duly signed digitally shall be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form /letter head if attached by vendors shall be straightaway ignored and shall not be considered. 5. The tenderers shall submit a certificate as given in tender document as "Annexure" in standard format without which their tender may not be considered and shall be summarily rejected. 6. The supplier / contractor of goods and / or services would be subject to GST Act and Rules as applicable from time to time. 7. Document being attached should be signed by the tenderer on its body. 8. This tender notice has also been uploaded on www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in. 9. Payment of Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) in respect of e-tendering shall be accepted through net banking or payment gateway only. 10. In case of any difficulty helpline available on the website of IREPS may be approached. 11. Tender on line can be submitted up to 13:30 hrs. of tender opening date i.e. 16.09.2026. 12. The tenderer has to submit necessary documents in compliance of clause 10 to 18 (Part-I) of GCC-2022 mandatorily, otherwise offer will be considered as Incomplete Offer and accordingly shall not be considered. 1919/26 (D)

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in CPRONC

**ICICI Bank**

Regd. Office: ICICI Bank Limited, Landmark, Race Course Circle, Vadodra- 390007

Corporate Office: ICICI Bank Towers, Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (E), Mumbai- 400051

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Ltd., Shal Tower, Plot No 23, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, Delhi 110005

Notice for Disclosure of Legal Heirs of Deceased Borrower

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given that Home Loan LBDEL00004738288 (Credit facility) was granted to KRISHNA CHAUHAN along with the deceased ALOK SINGH CHAUHAN by ICICI Bank Ltd. (The Bank).

We would like to inform you that the demise of ALOK SINGH CHAUHAN has come to our knowledge during field visits conducted by the Bank officials and by telephonic communications on the registered contact numbers. In this regard, letter dated AUGUST 19, 2026, was previously sent to the registered addresses of the Borrowers and the Deceased ALOK SINGH CHAUHAN, for providing information about the Legal Heirs of the Deceased Borrower.

Therefore, this Notice is hereby given for sharing details of the Legal Heirs of the deceased ALOK SINGH CHAUHAN with supporting documents for updating the Bank's records, within 15 days of publication of this Notice.

You may submit the above-mentioned details to Mr. GOVIND SINGH by visiting ICICI BANK LTD PLOT NO. 7, COMMUNITY CENTRE S.D. TOWER, SECTOR 8, ROHINI.

Date : August 21, 2026
Place : Delhi/NCR

SD Authorised Officer
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82(2)(ii) Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person namely **Nikhil S/o Ramesh Chand, R/o: H. No. F-21/31, Vijay Vihar, Ph-1, Sector-4, Rohini** (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 117/19, U/s 356/379/411/34 IPC**, registered at P.S.: North Rohini, Delhi and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused **Nikhil** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Nikhil** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Nikhil** accused **FIR No. 117/19, U/s 356/379/411/34 IPC**, registered at P.S.: North Rohini, Delhi is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.10.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Aakanksha
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
North-West, Court No. 107, 1st Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/11616/RD/2026
(Court Matter)

**SOUTH INDIAN Bank**

The South Indian Bank Ltd
Regional Office-Delhi, 3rd Floor, Plot No.21, 21/1, Pusa Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi -110005
Phone-011 4233 1664/011 4512 8661
Email-ro1008@sib.co.in.

Date: 20-08-2026

Ref: DEL/CRD/SAR/33/2026-27

E- AUCTION SALE NOTICE

E-Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) and 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

1. **M/s. Shri Gangadas Textile Industries Limited**, 7098 Shop no. 1, Jain Market, Guru Nanak Gali, Gandhi Nagar, Delhi- 110 031. Also at: F 224, Focal Point, Phase VIII, Chandigarh Road, Ludhiana, Punjab 141 010. Also at: Ground & First Floor, Property no. 2, M/S GG Fabrics under proprietorship of **Mr. Nitin Dawar** at F 224, Focal Point, Phase VIII, Chandigarh Road, Ludhiana Punjab-141 010

3. **Mr. Pankaj Ahuja** 4181, 04 Duragpur Haibowal, Kalan, Ludhiana, Punjab- 141 001

4. **Mrs. Hema Ahuja** 4181, 04 Duragpur Haibowal, Kalan, Ludhiana, Punjab 141 001

5. **Mr. Rakesh Kumar** 74/2, Ram Nagar Extension, Krishna Nagar, Delhi 110 051

6. **Mr. Suresh Kumar** 74/2, Ram Nagar Extension, Krishna Nagar, Delhi 110 051

7. **Mr. Vinay Dawar** House No. 267, Block A, Rajguru Nagar, Ludhiana, Punjab 141 012

8. **Mr. Nitin Dawar**, House No. 267, Block A, Rajguru Nagar, Ludhiana, Punjab 141 012 (Personal guarantor and legal heir of late Ramesh Kumar).

9. **Mrs. Shivani Kochar**, 74/2, Ram Nagar Extension, Krishna Nagar, Delhi 110 051, also at, House No.267, Block A, Rajguru Nagar, Ludhiana, Punjab 141012 (Legal heir of late Ramesh Kumar)

10. **Mrs. Savita Dawar**, House No. 267, Block A, Rajguru Nagar, Ludhiana, Punjab 141012, also at, Daurer 504 Block GX, BRS Nagar Extension, Opposite Verka Milk Plant, Ferozepur Road, Ludhiana-141012, also at 74/2, Ram Nagar Extension, Krishna Nagar, Delhi-110051

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the borrower/guarantor/Legal heirs that the below described immovable properties mortgaged to the South Indian Bank Ltd. Branch Vasundhara (Secured Creditor), the Physical Possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of The South Indian Bank Limited (Secured Creditor), will be sold on "as is where is" basis, "as is what is" and "whatever there is" condition on 08-09-2026 for recovery of an amount of Rs. 16,92,38,143.26/- (Rupees Sixteen Crore Ninety Two Lakh Thirty Eight Thousand One Hundred Forty Three and Twenty Six Paise Only) as on 18-02-2026, with future interest, costs and expenses etc, thereon due to The South Indian Bank Limited, Branch Vasundhara (Secured Creditor), from the above mentioned Borrower(s) and guarantor(s).

Item No.1

Name of Property Owner	Late Mr. Ramesh Kumar (Now represented by legal heirs Mrs. Savita Dawar, Mr. Vinay Dawar, Mr. Nitin Dawar and Mrs. Shivani Kochar), Mr. Rakesh Kumar and Mr. Suresh Kumar
Description of property	All that Part and Parcel of Freehold Residential Property measuring 50 square yards out of area measuring 100 sq. yds, out of total area measuring 218 sq. yds, out of Khassa no. 464/362 along with Residential Buildings constructed upon it bearing no. MPL 783/18-A/5 (old), New No. IX/7172 along with all other constructions, improvements, Easementary Rights existing and appurtenant thereon situated at Gaur Nanak Gali, Gandhi Nagar, Village Seelampur, Illaga Shahdara, Delhi 110 031 owned by Late Ramesh Kumar Dawar (since expired and represented by his legal heirs; Mrs. Savita Dawar , Mr. Vinay Dawar, Mr. Nitin Dawar and Mrs. Shivani Kochar), Mr. Rakesh Kumar and Mr. Suresh Kumar more particularly described under Sale Deed No. 1287 dated 09-05-1989 at SRO -IV, New Delhi/Delhi and Will dated 02-06-1997 bounded on North by Common Passage, South by Other's property, East by Common wall & Shop No.7 and west by common wall and shop No.5
Reserve Price (Item No.1)	Rs. 1,44,50,000/- (Rupees One Crore Forty Four Lakh Fifty Thousand Only)
Earnest Money Deposit (EMD) (Item No.1)	Rs. 14,45,000/- (Rupees Fourteen Lakhs Forty-Five Thousand Only) EMD shall be deposited on or before 07.09.2026 till 02.00 PM
Bid Increment (amount Item No.1)	Rs. 10,000/- (Rupees Ten Thousand Only)
Date and time of E-auction (Item No.1)	08.09.2026 from 11:00 AM to 11:30 AM (with 5 minute unlimited auto extensions till sale is concluded)
Encumbrances known to the Bank (Item No.1)	Nil/ Encumbrances from 01.01.2018 to 22.11.2022

For detailed terms and conditions of the sale, please refer to the link provided in web portal of South Indian Bank Ltd. (Secured Creditor) website i.e. www.southindianbank.com. Details also available at <https://bankauctions.in>.

For any further clarification with regards to inspection of property, terms and conditions of the e-auction or submission of bids, kindly contact South Indian Bank Ltd on 9037-854-719 (contact number).

SD/- AUTHORISED OFFICER

**ICICI Bank**

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No.-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice.

Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	Pankaj Mittal/ Sanjay/ LBDEL00002094016	Flat No. B-19/4, 19th Floor, Tower B, "Himalaya Pride" Situated At Plot No. 10 B, Techzone IV, Greater Noida Uttar Pradesh- 201307/ August 18, 2026	April 16, 2026 Rs. 33,54,425/-	Delhi NCR
2.	Neelam Rai/ Vikrant Bhandari/ LBDEL00002115515	Flat No. 2001, 20th Floor, Tower-A2, Eco Village-1, Situated At Plot No.8, Sector-1, Greater Noida, Noida Uttar Pradesh- 201303/ August 18, 2026	January 10, 2025 Rs. 13,14,441.64/-	Delhi NCR

The above-mentioned borrower(s)/guarantor(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold on after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: August 21, 2026
Place: Delhi/Ncr

Sincerely Authorised Officer,
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

**ICICI Bank**

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No. 23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005

The undersigned being the Authorised Officer of ICICI Bank Limited under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13 (12) R/w Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) rules 2002, issued demand notices upon the borrowers mentioned below, (on the underlying pool assigned to ICICI Bank by Devan Housing Finance Ltd.) in relation to the enforcement of security with respect to a Housing Loan facility granted, pursuant to a loan agreement entered into between DHFL and the borrower, to repay the amount mentioned in the notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice.

As the borrower failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described herein below in the exercise of powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower(s) (DHFL Old LAN & ICICI New LAN)	Description of Property/ Date of symbolic possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (₹)	Name of Branch
1.	Mohesh Kumar- Deceased (Through His Legal Heir/ Anita Kumari/ Loan No. (24900001536)/ QZJNK00004998737/ Plot No. 14, Gali No. 1, Sector 2, Sainikenclove, Mohangarden, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi, Delhi 110059	Built Up Property Bearing No. E-12/1 And E-12/2, First Floor, Towards Back Side Right Hand Side, Without Roof/ Terrace Rights, Out of Khassa No. 561, With One Two-Wheeler Parking, Situated In The Area of Village Nowada Majra Hasteen, Delhi State Abadi Known As Mohan Garden, In Block-E, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi- 110059./ August 18, 2026	February 25, 2026 Rs. 33,04,625.01/-	Delhi Ncr

The above-mentioned borrower(s)/ guarantor(s) are hereby given a 30 day notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold on the expiry of 30 days from the date of publication of this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

Date: August 00, 2026
Place: Delhi/ Ncr

Authorized Officer
ICICI Bank Limited

**SOUTH INDIAN Bank**

The South Indian Bank Ltd
Regional Office - Delhi,
3rd Floor, Plot No.21, 21/1, Pusa Road, Karol Bagh,
New Delhi - 110005. Phone - 011 4233 1664/
011 4512 8661, email - ro1008@sib.co.in.

E- AUCTION SALE NOTICE

E-Auction Sale Notice for Sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) and 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

1. **M/s. Savemax Wholesale Club Private Limited**, 401 'D' Mall, Netaji Subhash Place, New Delhi-110034. Also at: 806-807, Udyog Vihar, Phase V, Gurgaon, Haryana-122001.

2. **Mr. Vaibhav Singhal**, S/o Sh. Gian Chand Singhal, 25/75 Shakti Nagar, Delhi- 110007.

3. **Mrs. Seema Gupta**, W/o Sh. Gian Chand Singhal, 25/75 Shakti Nagar, Delhi- 110007.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the borrowers / guarantors that the below described immovable property mortgaged to the South Indian Bank Ltd, Branch Karol Bagh (Secured Creditor), the Physical possession of which has been taken by the Authorised Officer of The South Indian Bank Limited (Secured Creditor), will be sold on "as is where is" basis, "as is what is" and "whatever there is" condition on 09.09.2026 for recovery of an amount of Rs. 38,93,34,932.59 (Rupees Thirty Eight Crore Ninety Three Lakh Thirty Four Thousand Nine Hundred and Thirty Two and fifty nine paise only) as on 19.08.2026 with future interest, costs and expenses etc, thereon due to The South Indian Bank Limited, Branch Karol Bagh (Secured Creditor), from the above mentioned borrower(s) and guarantor(s).

Name of Property Owner	M/s Savemax Wholesale Club Private Limited
Description of property	All that part and parcel of commercial unit no.A-42, admeasuring super area 2808 sq. ft on Atrium Floor of commercial complex known as "Parker Mall" situated at G.T Road, N.H. 1, Sector-62, Kundli, Sonapat, Haryana morefully described in conveyance deed bearing no. 2853 dated 21.11.2016 registered with Sub-Registrar-Rai, Sonapat Haryana, owned and possessed by M/s. Savemax Wholesale Club Private Limited - bounded on the North: Passage & Unit No. A-37, South: Side Set Back /Drive way, East: Unit No. A-41, West: Unit No. A-43.
Reserve Price	Rs. 74,63,960.00 (Rupees Seventy Four Lakh Sixty Three Thousand Nine Hundred and Sixty only)
Earnest Money Deposit (EMD)	Rs. 7,46,396.00 (Rupees Seven Lakh Forty Six Thousand Three Hundred and Ninety Six only) EMD shall be deposited on or before 05.09.2026 by 5.00 PM
Bid Increment amount	Rs. 10,000/- (Rupees Ten Thousand Only)
Date and time of E-auction	09.09.2026 from 10:00 AM to 2:00 PM (with 5 minute unlimited auto extensions till sale is concluded)

SATWIK-CHIRAG ENTER QUARTERS AS SINDHU, AYUSH OUSTED

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

New Delhi, August 20

Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty stood one step away from a third medal after progressing to the men's doubles quarterfinals but India suffered a big blow at the World Championships following the ouster of PV Sindhu and Ayush Shetty in the singles competition here on Thursday.

Satwik and Chirag, who won two bronze medals in 2022 and 2025, rallied their way to a hard-fought 21-23 21-19 21-17 win over Malaysia's world No. 19 pair of Junaidi Arif and Yap Roy King in the pre-quarterfinals.

It was their first match of the tournament following a first-round bye and second-round walkover.

However, two-time Olympic medallist Sindhu's hopes of winning an unprecedented sixth World Championships medal ended with a grueling 11-21 21-15 17-21 loss to China's world No. 3 Wang Zhi Yi, who battled severe cramps in both legs in the final stages to advance to the quarterfinals.

"I don't know if she had an injury or what, maybe that was her tactics and her way of doing it," Sindhu told reporters after the match.



Wang Zhi Yi celebrates defeating PV Sindhu; right: Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty after their win



"I have to be focused and I was, but again each point matters, right? At that point, even though she takes a break or not, if she is injured or not, you never know. It does hurt a lot more because after you train and work hard for so long, losing these kind of matches definitely hurts a lot. But I think it is a game, that is how it is supposed to be."

Earlier, the 21-year-old Shetty, who had created a flutter by stunning defend-

IN SHORT

» Sindhu had a flawless record against the Chinese in the World Championships, a 3-5 head-to-head record against Wang

» Treesa Jolly and Gayatri Gopichand also moved a step closer to a maiden medal by reaching the quarterfinals with a straight-game win

ing champion and world No. 1 Shi Yu Qi in the opening round, went down 19-21 11-21 to world No. 12 Alwi Farhan.

It was his fifth defeat in eight meetings against the 11th-seeded Indonesian, bringing the curtains down on India's men's singles campaign.

India's women's doubles pair of Treesa Jolly and Gayatri Gopichand also moved a step closer to a maiden medal by reaching the quarterfinals with

a straight-game win over Japanese seventh seeds Rin Iwanaga and Kie Nakaniishi. The unseeded Indian pair, on a comeback trail after Treesa recovered from an injury, produced a dominant performance to outwit the world No. 7 Japanese pair 21-16 21-12.

It was the first quarterfinal appearance by an Indian women's doubles pair at the World Championships since Jwala Gutta and Ashwini Ponnappa achieved the feat in 2015.

Neeraj, Pathirage renew rivalry in Lausanne DL

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Lausanne, August 20

The budding rivalry between rising Sri Lankan star Ramesh Pathirage and Indian ace Neeraj Chopra will once again be an intriguing battle when the two square off in the Lausanne Diamond League meet here on Friday with a spot in the DL grand finale in Brussels at stake.

The duo will be up against each other three weeks after Pathirage clinched the gold and Chopra finished with a silver in the Glasgow Common-



wealth Games.

The 23-year-old Pathirage has been in the form of his life this season, having also won the Doha and Rome Diamond League meetings, besides clinching gold in Glasgow with a

throw of 89.75m. He also breached the coveted 90m mark with a season-leading throw of 92.62m in Rome in June.

In fact, the Sri Lankan has won eight of the nine competitions he has partic-

ipated so far in the season.

Chopra, on the other hand, is on a comeback trail after recovering from a lower back injury that has troubled him since September last year.

The injury delayed his return until the Diamond League in Doha. He was not 100 per cent fit in Glasgow but was able to win a silver with a season's best throw of 85.83m.

"I can't say my fitness is there like before. But I'm getting there slowly," the 28-year-old Chopra had said at the Glasgow Commonwealth Games.

'Rukna Nahi Hai': JSW brings hockey legends together to back India at WC

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, August 20

Few nations have dominated and revolutionised a sport quite like India has in hockey.

From the unmatched golden run at the Olympics beginning in 1928 to the historic World Cup triumph in 1975, India's hockey legacy is a story worth reliving again and again. As another World



Cup gets underway, JSW Group celebrates this rich history by continuing its flagship 'Rukna Nahi Hai' campaign as a tribute to India's enduring

sporting spirit.

Parth Jindal, founder & director, JSW Sports, said: "Hockey is deeply woven into India's sporting identity, and at JSW, we are proud to have played our small part in helping the sport and its athletes receive the recognition they deserve. 'Rukna Nahi Hai' is our way of celebrating the incredible legacy of Indian hockey and standing behind teams."

India escape with draw against England, advance to Rd 2

End second in the pool with one win and two draws

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Amstelveen, August 20

The Indian women's hockey team advanced to the second round of the FIH World Cup after being held to a goalless draw by England in their final Pool D match here on Thursday, surviving a dozen penalty corners and late pressure.

India, who needed only a draw to progress, finished second in the pool with one win and two draws from three matches. China topped the group after beating South Africa 5-1 earlier in the day.

The result, however, masked a below-par performance from India, who struggled with passing, ball control and penalty-corner execution.

They earned six penalty corners but failed to convert any, with Deepika and Navneet Kaur unable to make their opportunities count.

India's goalkeepers Savita Punia and Bichhu Devi stood out, particularly as England earned as many as 11 penalty corners during the match.

Bichhu produced the crucial save with just 30



India and England vie for the ball

THEY EARNED SIX PENALTY CORNERS BUT FAILED TO CONVERT ANY, WITH DEEPIKA AND NAVNEET KAUR UNABLE TO MAKE THEIR OPPORTUNITIES COUNT

seconds remaining, diving to her left to deny England and preserve India's qualification. India and China will carry one point each in the second round.

India started aggressively and earned three penalty corners in the

opening 15 minutes. Their first chance came in the fourth minute when Sunelita sent the injection, but Navneet's attempt appeared to have gone in off Ishika's stick, resulting in the goal being disallowed.

Navneet's attempt from India's second penalty corner went wide before Deepika failed to find the target with the third

England responded with counter-attacks and earned their first penalty corner in the 10th minute. Sunelita produced an excellent save to deny Sophie Hamilton's drag-flick, while Jyoti cleared the danger.

EB rewrite history in huge win

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Kota Kinabalu, August 20

East Bengal FC secured their second consecutive victory after romping to a 12-0 win over Rovers FC (Guam) in the AFC Women's Champions League 2026-27 preliminary stage here on Thursday.

In doing so, they created history by recording the biggest-ever victory by an Indian club in an Asian competition, whether men's or women's.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

SEE SECTION 82 CR.P.C./ 84 BHARTIYA NAGARIK SURAKSHA SANHITA

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Goutam** S/o Bitto R/o H. No. 10989, Peepal Wali Gali, Near Sadar Bazar Thana, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence FIR No. 574/2020 u/s 377/506/34 IPC & 06 PCOSO Act at P.S. Mukherjee Nagar, Delhi and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Goutam** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Goutam** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s 82 Cr. P.C./84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Goutam** accused of FIR No. 574/2020 u/s 377/506/34 IPC & 06 PCOSO Act at P.S. Mukherjee Nagar, Delhi is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **08.10.2026**.

By Order: Ms. Pooja Jain,
Addl. Sessions Judge-05 (PCOSO) (North)
Room No. 302, 3rd Floor,
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/11650/NW/2026

BSES BSES Rajdhani Power Limited, New Delhi

TENDER NOTICE Date: 21.08.2026

Sealed tenders under two Bid System (Unpriced & Priced) is invited for following job from all bidders.

NIT No.	Brief Item Description	Due Date & Time of Submission	Date & Time of Opening
CMC/BR/26-27/	ENGAGEMENT OF CONSULTANCY FIRM AS TECHNOLOGY	10.09.2026	10.09.2026
FK/CR/SS/1385	CONSULTANT UNDER PROJECT ARJUNA 2028 IN BRPL.	15:00 HRS	15:15 HRS

For details in respect of Equipment/BOM/Services, Qualifying requirements, Terms & conditions, purchase/submit of tender documents etc. Please visit our website www.bsesdelhi.com Head (Contracts & Materials)

Regd. Off.: BSES Rajdhani Power Limited, BSES Bhawan, Nehru Place, New Delhi-110019 | Corporate Identification No.: U40108DL2001PLC111527
Telephone No.: +91 11 4910 7235 | Website: www.bsesdelhi.com

M.P. MADHYA KSHETRA VIDYUT VITARAN CO. LTD.
(Government of M.P. Undertaking)
Office of The General Manager (O&M) Circle, Narmadapuram
Phone No. : 07574-255594, Fax No. : 07574-256180
E-mail ID : mpczgmhoshangabad@gmail.com

No. : GM/O&M/Pur/3947 Narmadapuram, Dated : 20.08.2026

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDERS (TS No.-05)

E-Tender (RCA) are invites from the eligible bidders for carrying out the following work :-

Name of Works	App.Value of Tender (In Cr.) Including GST	EMD Fee (In. Rs.)	Tender Fee (In. Rs.)	Tender Submission Last Date & Time	Opening Date of Tender Documents
Empanelment of Agencies for new 33/11kV substation, additional/Augmentation of PTR at existing 33/11 KV S/s, HT Lines, LT Lines, DTR, Service Line, meter related works and any other associated works as per SOR schedules in Narmadapuram Circle of MPMKVCL.	10.00 Cr.	100000/-	(11800 with 18% GST)	07.09.2026 Up to 15.00 Hrs.	08.09.2026 at 15:30 Hrs.

Other details, terms and conditions are available on company website : <https://portal.mpcz.in> & <https://mptenders.gov.in> or the under signed office.
M.P. Madhyam/127682/2026 GM (O&M)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No.: Jhansi/WIT/Tender General/190 Date: 18/08/2026

E-TENDERING TENDER NOTICE

Divisional Railway Manager (Works) N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No.: JHS-ENG-E-2026-190

Description of work: Rehabilitation of RCC BOX of LHS and other associated works at Subway no. 412, 425, 431 under ADEN/MBA jurisdictions.

Approx Cost : 13580414.95 **Earnest Money:** 2716000.00

Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter : 06 Months

Date of closing Tender : 14.09.2026 at 15:00 hrs. Tender online can be submitted up to 15:00 hrs on 14.09.2026. For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in 1911/26(D)

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPONCR

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Tender Notice

Invitation of tender through E-tendering (e-Procurement Systems)

NIT No.	26-RCNK-OPN-FUR-2026
Name of Work and its location	Tender for "Furnishing Work (Mechanical & Electrical) of Vande Bharat Rakes during SS-II at RCNK/SNP for a period of one year (As per Scope of Work)"
Approx. Cost of work	Tender Cost: Rs 5,74,62,995.26/- including GST (Rs. Five Crore Seventy Four Lakh Sixty-Two Thousand Nine Hundred Ninety-Five and Twenty-Six paise only)
Earnest Money	Rs. 11,49,300,00/-
Completion period of work	12 months from date of LOA
Cost of Tender document on cash/by post	NIL
Date and Time for submission of tender and opening of tender	Upto 15:00 hrs on 11/09/2026
Website particulars notice board location complete details of tender can be seen	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in
Tender No. 26-RCNK-OPN-FUR-2026	
Dated: - 19/08/2026	2893/2026

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M.P. STATE AGRICULTURAL MARKETING BOARD

26- ARERA HILLS JAIL ROAD, BHOPAL

No./Const./BN/Sagar/26-27/430 Bhopal, Dated : 19.08.2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Online Percentage Rate E-Tenders are invited from contractors registered with the Office of the Engineer in Chief, M.P. Public Works Department, Government of Madhya Pradesh (Centralized Registration Cell) for : **Tender Number: 2026_MPSAM_530828 (PAC amount Rs. 228.16 Lakh)** Construction of High-Rise shed at Mandi yard Khurai, CC work around High-Rise shed at Mandi yard Khurai and Repair and painting work of Existing structure at Mandi yard Khurai **2026_MPSAM_530829 (PAC amount Rs. 16.84 Lakh)** External electrification work at Mandi Yard Khurai.

The following works **Tender to be Received online up to 17:00 on 11.09.2026**. Technical bid documents with EMD & Financial Offer to be received online only as per Detailed NIT.

The tender documents can be obtained online on the <http://mptenders.gov.in> as per the Notice Published on the above Portal and detailed information can also be seen on website www.mpmmandiboard.gov.in

Note : Any corrigendum in this NIT, if required, shall be displayed only in our above portal regarding any matter included in this NIT or otherwise. Other details of Construction/ Development works and locations & key dates can also be seen on our website www.mpmmandiboard.gov.in

EXECUTIVE ENGINEER (Project cell)

M.P. Madhyam/127672/2026

LOST & FOUND

Application No. 132270992600557

I, Dharampal Kataria R/o H.No. 136/28 Gali No. 1, Near Ashirwad Lawn Jyoti Park, District Gurugram Haryana, have Lost/Misplaced of Original Sale deed vide vasika no. 618 DT. 27.04.1987 in favour of Sh. Viender Singh S/o Dayachand of plot no. 133/28, khasra no. 6621/861/6, jyoti Park, Gurugram. That any misuse of the property documents by any other person, he/she/they will only be liable and responsible for the same. Finder Pls Cont. No.: 9810156937

millenniumpost CLASSIFIEDS

CHANGE OF NAME

It is for general information that I, NITIKA MAURYA W/o VIJAY KUMAR MAURYA R/o B-50/51 F No- 4 Floor, Hindon Vihar, Sector-49, Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh: 201301 declare that name of mine and my husband have been wrongly written as NITIKA KUSHWAHA and VIJAY MAURYA in my minor daughter namely SWASTI MAURYA aged 13 years in her school record. The actual name of mine and my husband are NITIKA MAURYA and VIJAY KUMAR MAURYA respectively which may be amended accordingly.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Rajeev Kumar Sharma** Director of Partisha Bazar Pvt. Ltd. at 514,515, Laxmi Deep Building, Above HDFC Bank, Laxmi Nagar, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence case **CC No. 1930/19 U/S 138 NI Act. at P.S. Bhajanpura, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Rajeev Kumar Sharma** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Rajeev Kumar Sharma** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding u/s **84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita** has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Rajeev Kumar Sharma** accused of **CC No. 1930/19 U/S 138 NI Act. at P.S. Bhajanpura, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **22.09.2026**.

By Order: Ms. Kiran Deep Kaur,
Judicial Magistrate First Class-01,
North-East Distt., Court No. 5,
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi.

DP/11730/NE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Jagdish Grover**, S/o: Charanjeet Lal Grover, R/o: H. No. T-2540, Hardayal Singh Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi; also at D-155, Rajender Nagar, New Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 98/2011, U/s 279/337/338 IPC, P.S.: Jagatpuri, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Jagdish Grover** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Jagdish Grover** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Jagdish Grover** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 98/2011, U/s 279/337/338 IPC, P.S.: Jagatpuri, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **24.09.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Anushtha Srivastava
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05
Room No. 07, Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/11639/SHD/2026
(Court Matter)

KIND ATTENTION RAIL PASSENGER !

RAKSHA BANDHAN SPECIAL TRAINS

In order to clear extra rush of passengers on the occasion of Raksha Bandhan, Railways have decided to run the following Special Trains as per schedule given below :-

Train 01701/01702 Jabalpur Jn.-Hazrat Nizamuddin- Jabalpur Jn. Raksha Bandhan Special Train					
Train No. 01701		STATIONS	Train No. 01702		
Arr.	Dep.		Arr.	Dep.	
----	20.20	Jabalpur Jn.	09.30	----	
21.35	21.40	Katni Murwara	06.10	06.15	
22.55	22.57	Damoh	04.40	04.42	
00.15	00.20	Saugor	03.30	03.35	
05.50	05.55	Virangana Lakshmbai Jhansi Jn.	00.05	00.10	
07.30	07.35	Gwalior Jn.	22.25	22.30	
08.50	08.52	Dholpur Jn.	21.18	21.20	
09.30	09.35	Agra Cantt	20.30	20.35	
11.10	11.15	Mathura Jn.	19.35	19.40	
11.43	11.45	Kosi Kalan	17.50	17.52	
14.25	----	Hazrat Nizamuddin	----	15.45	

Days of Run: 01701 Ex Jabalpur Jn. on 29.08.2026 (Saturday) & 01702 Ex Hazrat Nizamuddin on 30.08.2026 (Sunday)
Accommodation: 2 Tier AC, 3 Tier AC, Sleeper & General

Train 09803/09804 Kota Jn.-Hazrat Nizamuddin- Kota Jn. Raksha Bandhan Special Train					
Train No. 09803		STATIONS	Train No. 09804		
Arr.	Dep.		Arr.	Dep.	
----	22.15	Kota Jn.	19.35	----	
23.05	23.07	Indargarh Sumerganj Mandi	17.53	17.55	
23.48	23.50	Sawai Madhopur Jn.	17.28	17.30	
00.35	00.37	Gangapur City	15.55	15.57	
01.05	01.07	Shri Mahaveerji	15.10	15.12	
01.18	01.20	Hindaun City	14.55	14.57	
01.40	01.42	Bayana Jn.	14.20	14.22	
02.18	02.20	Bharatpur Jn.	13.23	13.25	
04.20	04.25	Mathura Jn.	12.30	12.35	
07.00	----	Hazrat Nizamuddin	----	09.00	

Days of Run: 09803 Ex Kota Jn. on 22.08.2026, 24.08.2026 & 26.08.2026 & 09804 Ex Hazrat Nizamuddin on 23.08.2026, 25.08.2026 & 27.08.2026.
Accommodation: 1st AC cum 2 Tier AC, 2 Tier AC, 3 Tier AC, 3 Tier AC (Economy), Sleeper & General

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr.PC/84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Amit Kumar**, S/o Santosh Kumar R/o H.No.Jhuggi No.140, Opposite MIG Flats, Block-K, Jahangir Puri, New Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.0311/2018 dated 09.11.2018 u/s 279/338 IPC, P.S. New Friends Colony, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Amit Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Amit Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Amit Kumar** of **FIR No.0311/2018 dated 09.11.2018 u/s 279/338 IPC, P.S. New Friends Colony, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **28.09.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Vinod Joshi
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate, South-East District
Room No.515, Saket Courts, New Delhi

DP/11642/SE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Pradeep Kumar @ Gopal Singh S/o Bhagwan Singh R/o A-178, Mehrauli, Delhi** and Village Padampuri, P.S. Dhari, Uttarakhand has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 384/2007 U/s 420/467 IPC, P.S. Kotwali, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Pradeep Kumar @ Gopal Singh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Pradeep Kumar @ Gopal Singh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Pradeep Kumar @ Gopal Singh** of case **FIR No. 384/2007 U/s 420/467 IPC, P.S. Kotwali, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **22.09.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Sayesha Chadha
Judicial Magistrate First Class
Central, Room No. 272
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/11592/N/2026 (Court Matter)

BSES Yamuna Power Limited, Delhi

... A joint venture with Govt. of NCT of Delhi

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

Date: 21.08.2026

E-tender is invited under the Two-Bid System (Unpriced & Priced) for the following work:

NIT No.	Brief Description	Due Date & Time of Submission	Date & Time of Opening
NIT No: CMC/BY/26-27/RB/PM/AVS/29	Engagement of Consultancy Firm as Technology Consultant under Project Arjuna 2028 in BYPL	10.09.2026, 11:00 HRS	10.09.2026, 11:30 HRS

For details with respect to Equipment/BOM/Services, Qualifying requirements, Terms & conditions, purchase/submission of tender documents, corrigendum etc. please visit our website www.bsesselheli.com --> BSES YAMUNA POWER LTD--> Tender--> Open Tenders.

Head (Contracts & Materials)

Regd.Off: BSES Yamuna Power Ltd, Shakti Kiran Building, Karkardooma, Delhi-110032 | CIN: U40109DL2001PLC111525 Website: www.bsesselheli.com TEL: 011-41247111

COURT NOTICE

U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC (SUCCESSION CASE)

IN THE COURT OF Sh. Parvesh Singla Civil Judge (Senior Division), Sirsa ANOOP

Vs. GENERAL PUBLIC

Petition under section 372 of the Indian Succession Act, for grant of succession Certificate regarding the amount of Rs. 3,19,916/- on 13.05.2026 deposited in The Sirsa Central Co-operative Bank Limited, Sirsa in Account no. 002134007101175 in the name of Hardei (since deceased) grand mother of the petitioner, alongwith interest thereon upto date in favour of the petitioner being the grand son and legal heir of Smt. Hardei since deceased, on the basis of evidence of every description-oral as well as documentary.

CNR No. HR5102-000731-2026

Next Date: 03-09-2026

NOTICE TO: GENERAL PUBLIC

In above titled case, the defendant(s) respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 03-09-2026 at 10:00 am.

For details login to <https://highcourtshd.gov.in/7med=districtnotice&distric=Sirsa>

Sd/-Sh. Parvesh Singla

Civil Judge (Senior Division)

dated 19.08.2026

For detailed information regarding stoppages and timings of above train, please call RailMadad Helpline No. 139 or visit enquiry website: www.enquiry.indianrail.gov.in or NTES App.

RailMadad Helpline No. 139

Visit RailMadad website:- www.railmadad.indianrailways.gov.in Download RailMadad app.

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H. O. "UJJWAL" MAHARANI BAGH, GMS ROAD, DEHRADUN - 248006, CIN No. U40101UR2001SG0025866

Tele.: 0135-2763508, 2763808, Fax: 0135-2763507, website: www.ujvnl.com

Tender No.709

Date : 20.08.2026

E-TENDER NOTICE

Office of the Executive Engineer (Generation) Chibro Power House, Chibro, invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below:

Tender No. 06e/EE(G)/CPH/2026-27.

Name of work/supply/services: "Annual Contract for miscellaneous work of operation and maintenance at Chibro Power House".

Estimated costs: Rs.63,75,442/- GST Extra,

Date of availability of tender on website: 21-08-2026 from 10:00 Hrs.

Last date for submission of bids on website: 11-09-2026 up to 15:00 Hrs.

For fuller & further details, kindly visit our website. The tender documents can be downloaded from the Nigam's website "www.ujvnl.com"

EE(G), Chibro

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

झापाक:-02/पी०पी०ओ०/2024/76

पुलिस वायरलेस मुख्यालय झारखण्ड, राँची

दिनांक 20/08/2026

अत्यकालीन निविदा आमंत्रण संख्या:- 04/2026-27/पी०पी०ओ०

पुलिस वायरलेस मुख्यालय, राँची, झारखण्ड में वायरलेस कार्य के लिए Power Supply Unit (PSU) - 100 अद्व. के क्रय एवं आपूर्ति हेतु निविदादाताओं से मुहूर्त निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। वैसे उत्पादनकर्ता/विक्रेता/अधिकृत एजेंट निविदा दस्तावेज प्राप्त कर सकते हैं, जिनका GST रजिस्ट्रेशन निविदा आमंत्रण के तिथि के पूर्व प्राप्त हो। निविदा दस्तावेज एवं Power Supply Unit (PSU) का Technical Specification रु० 500/- (पाँच सौ रुपये) मात्र अप्रतिदेय (Non Refundable) का बैंक ड्राफ्ट मुगलान कर झारखण्ड पुलिस वायरलेस मुख्यालय, लाईन टैंक रोड, राँची 834001 के पी०पी०ओ०शाखा से प्राप्त कर सकते हैं। बैंक ड्राफ्ट पुलिस अधीक्षक (तकनीकी सेवाएँ एवं संचार) S.P.(Technical services and communication) के नाम होना चाहिए। निविदा प्राप्त करने की अन्तिम तिथि दि० 10.09.2026 समय 11:00 बजे। निविदा समर्पित करने की अन्तिम तिथि दि० 12.09.2026 समय 17:00 बजे। निविदा खोलने की तिथि दि० 15.09.2026 समय 11:00 बजे। पुलिस महानिदेशक (संचार एवं तक० सेवाएँ), झारखण्ड, राँची को यह अधिकार सुरक्षित है, कि बिना कारण बताये निविदा को अस्वीकृत कर दें या निष्क्रिय मद में आवश्यकतानुसार संख्या को घटा या बढ़ा दें। ह० प्रशांत आनन्द पुलिस अधीक्षक (संचार एवं तकनीकी सेवाएँ), झारखण्ड, राँची

PR 388049 Police Wireless Headquarter(26-27).D

Government of UT of Jammu & Kashmir

Office of the Executive Engineer

Mechanical Irrigation Division Anantnag HO Awantipora

Email: yxmidanantnaga@gmail.com

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

e-NIT No. 19 MIDA/2500-05 OF 2026-27 Dated: 20-08-2026

For and on behalf of Lt. Governor of UT of J&K Executive Engineer, Mechanical Irrigation Division, Anantnag, invites e-tenders on item rate basis by e-tendering mode for the advertised work. The bidding process shall be completed online in two covers viz. Cover '1st' consisting of Tender fee, Earnest Money Deposit, Prequalification criteria's, acceptance of General Terms and Conditions and Technical Specifications. Cover '2nd' shall consist of Financial Bid in the prescribed BOQ.

S. No	Name of work	Estimated Cost (Rs. in Lacs)	Cost of tender document/ (Rs.)	Earnest money @2%	Time of Completion of work
1	2	3	4	5	6
I.	LIS Khudpora-Providing & fitting of busbars/ cable for interconnection of motors and other electrical gadgets at Scheme 1 Stage 2 nd .	10.38	500/=	20760/=	30 days

Position of AA accorded by Superintending Engineer Mechanical Circle Srinagar Vide No. 29-MCO of 2026-27 dt: 13-08-2026

Major Head 4701 UT capex

Publish Date	20	08	2026	at	4:00 PM
II Document Download/sale start Date	20 <td>08</td> <td>2026</td> <td>at</td> <td>4:00 PM</td>	08	2026	at	4:00 PM
III Bid submission start date	20 <td>08</td> <td>2026</td> <td>From</td> <td>5:00 PM</td>	08	2026	From	5:00 PM
IV Bid submission/Document download /sale end Date	09	09	2026	Upto	11:00 AM
V Date and time of Bid opening	09	09	2026	At 4:00 Noon or any date convenient to the Deptt.	

1. The complete bidding process shall be online on www.jktenders.gov.in

2. The pre bid meeting will be held in the office chamber of the Executive Engineer, Mechanical Irrigation Division, Anantnag

3. The Financial bids of the bidders shall be opened online in the office of the Executive Engineer, Mechanical Irrigation Division Anantnag.

4. In compliance with the instructions issued by the Chief Engineer, Irrigation & Flood Control Department, Kashmir vide letter No. CE/I&FC/DB/6518-47 dated 16.06.2026, all EMD and Tender Fee transactions shall be made through the designated bank account, the details of which are as under:

5. Account Name: Chief Engineer Kashmir Irrigation and Flood Control

Account Number: 036701020000608

IFSC Code: JAKA0TANKKEE

Bank: J&K Bank Ltd., Tankipora Branch

6. Note: the bidders are advised to read all conditions laid down in the NIT Carefully before uploading softcopy any short fall found in the soft copy the tender shall be rejected.

7. All Bidders have to submit an EMD amount equal to 2% of estimated value as bid security and the acknowledgement of the online EMD transaction shall be uploaded with the bid.

8. The bid shall remain open for acceptance for a period of 180 days from the date of opening of bids. If any bidder/ tenderer withdraws his bid/tender before the said period or makes any modifications in the terms and conditions of the bid, His earnest money shall stand forfeited.

9. Other details can be seen in the bidding documents from the website <http://jktenders.gov.in>.

10. Queries by email if any should be made at yxmidanantnaga@gmail.com

11. The earnest money shall be forfeited incase any bidder withdraws during the period of bid validity or the firm/contractor fails to execute the agreement after fixation of contract.

12. Conditional tenders shall not be accepted.

13. Intending bidders are advised to download attached Annexures "Instructions to bidders regarding e-Tendering Process" and "General Instructions for bidders" and go through its contents before uploading their bids.

MIDA/2500-05
Dated 20.08.2026
DIP No.DIPK-4797/26

Sd/-Executive Engineer
Mechanical Irrigation Division Anantnag
HQ Awantipora

HIMACHAL PRADESH PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT

e-Procurement Notice

INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)

The Executive Engineer, HPPWD, Rohru Distt. Shimla H.P. on behalf of Governor of H.P. invites item rate, bids, in electronic tendering system, in 2 cover system for the under mentioned work from the eligible and approved contractor/firms registered with HPPWD Department.

Sr. No.	Name of Work	Estimated Cost (Rs)	Starting date for downloading Bid	Earnest money	Deadline for submission bid
1	Providing Periodical maintenance on Baghi Khadralla Sangri Rohru road km 0/00 to 67/00(SH-: Providing and laying pot holes, Periodical maintenance at Rd 60/00 to 64/00) Under AMP 2026-27(MDR Road)	6492802/-	25-8-2026	108739/-	2-9-2026
2	Providing Periodical maintenance on Parsa Sekhal Bindal kainchi road km 0/00 to 10/00 SH-: Providing and laying pot holes, Periodical maintenance at Rd 6/00 to 9/00) Under AMP 2026-27(VR Road)	4869602	25-8-2026	97392/-	2-9-2026
3	Providing Periodical maintenance on link road village Soia km 0/00 to 3/340 SH-: Providing and laying pot holes, Periodical maintenance at Rd 0/00 to 3/340) Under AMP 2026-27(VR Road)	5421489	25-8-2026	108430/-	2-9-2026
4	Providing Periodical maintenance on link road Tupora Kuthari Khajgar deoti road km 0/00 to 19/680 SH-: Providing and laying pot holes, Periodical maintenance at Rd 14/00 to 19/680) Under AMP 2026-27(VR Road)	9219778/-	25-8-2026	184396/-	2-9-2026

The Bidders are advised to note other details for tenders and letter No.PWD(B) A(3) 1/2020 dated 12.01.2023 issued by secretary PW) to the Govt. of Himachal Pradesh Public Works Department from the department website www.jptenders.gov.in, and any corrigendum will be uploaded on the website only.Executive Engineer.

Executive Engineer
HPPWD Division Rohru
Distt Shimla HP

Ro.No 2808/2026-2027

ICICI Bank

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No. 23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005

The undersigned being the Authorised Officer of ICICI Bank Limited under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13 (12) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) rules 2002, issued demand notices upon the borrowers mentioned below, (on the underlying pool assigned to ICICI Bank by Dewan Housing Finance Ltd.) in relation to the enforcement of security with respect to a Housing Loan facility granted, pursuant to a loan agreement entered into between DHFL and the borrower, to repay the amount mentioned in the notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice.

As the borrower failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described herein below in the exercise of powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower(s) (DHFL Old L&N & ICICI New L&N)	Description of Property/ Date of symbolic possession	Date of Demand /Notice/ Amount in Demand (Notice %)	Name of Branch
1.	Sunil Kumar/ Renu Sharma (283000000737 & QZROH00005004074) & H No 1226, Tigri Pana Nindana Teh Mehram Nindana Haryana Rohtak- 124513	Araji Khewat No-784, Khatoni No 830, Killa No 152/1/1(6-12), 10/2(7-0), 11/1(0-11), Kite 3, Rakko 14 Kanal 3 Marle Ka 1/34 Part Bakdat 8 Marle,wakya Rakko Mouja Mohem, Dist Rohtak Rohtak Haryana 124501/ August 19, 2026	March 27, 2026 Rs. 19,19,303.01/-	Faridabad, Rohtak (Haryana)

The above-mentioned borrowers(s) guarantors(s) are hereby given a 30 day notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold on the expiry of 30 days from the date of publication of this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

Date: August 21, 2026

Place: Faridabad

Authorized Officer
ICICI Bank Limited

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Neeraj @ Badal**, S/o: Tej Singh R/o: C-8/396 Sultan puri, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Case Reg. No. 7489/23, FIR No. 853/22, U/s: 379/411 IPC, PS: North Rohini, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Neeraj @ Badal**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Neeraj @ Badal**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Neeraj @ Badal**, of **Case Reg. No. 7489/23, FIR No. 853/22, U/s: 379/411 IPC, PS: North Rohini, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.10.2026**.

By Order
Aakanksha
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03 1st Floor
North-West Court No. 107
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/11622/RD/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

No. CV/CS/CP/Misc./2026 (NOTICE FOR E-AUCTION) Date: 18.08.2026

Senior Divisional Commercial Manager, North Central Railway, Prayagraj in terms of Railway Board letter dated 13.06.2022 invites bids through E-Auction module of IREPS for Parking of following station/locations of Prayagraj Division.

PARKING

S.N.	Details of Parking Stand	Period	E-Auction catalogue No.	E-Auction Start Date & Time
1.	Parking Stand at Kanpur Anwarganj Railway Station.	01 years	PRY-J-MX PARKG-26	01.09.2026 at 12.30 hrs
2.	Parking Stand at Rura Railway Station.	03 years	PRY-J-MX PARKG-26	01.09.2026 at 12.40 hrs
3.	Parking Stand at Khurja Railway Station.	03 years	PRY-J-MX PARKG-26	01.09.2026 at 12.50 hrs
4.	Parking Stand at Phaphund Railway Station.	03 years	PRY-J-MX PARKG-26	01.09.2026 at 13.00 hrs
5.	Parking Stand at Panki Dham Railway Station.	03 years	PNKD-MX PARKG-26	02.09.2026 at 12.00 hrs

Interested bidders may please visit official website for e-auctioning i.e. www.ireps.gov.in for further details and participating in e-Auction. Important note: 1. Bidders, who wish to participate in the e-auction module should have valid Digital Signing Certificate (DSC) and same may be procured form any of certifying authority of controller of Certifying Authorities (CCA) Government of India, details of same may be obtained from www.cca.gov.in. 2. Prospective bidders will be required to get themselves registered online at IREPS (Commercial Auction Module). 3. One time registration fee of Rs. 10000.00/- and applicable GST (non-refundable) will be required to be paid online by the entity before participating in any commercial auction. 4. For more information, requirement and various aspects regarding this e-Auction, interested bidders are advised to visit <http://www.ireps.gov.in/epsn/jsp/common/learnCenter.jsp>. 5. Earning Money Deposit (EMD): 10% of the total contractual bid value to be deposited online during the auction, EMD of the successful bidder will be retained as Security Deposit. 6. Railway Administration reserves the full and absolute right to short terminate these contracts any point of time (or for taking any decision) depending upon the circumstances if any. 7. The successful bidder will also have to pay applicable GST as imposed by Govt. of India from time to time are applicable. Rail administration will not be responsible for this. 1903/26 (D)

North central railways www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ CPNCR

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Arun Kumar S/o Mahesh Kumar R/o H. No. RZ-195, I Block Gali No. 16 Tuglakabad Extension New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Case FIR 808/2023 U/s 356/379/411/34 IPC PS: Okhla Industrial Area, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Arun Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Arun Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Arun Kumar** accused of **FIR 808/2023 U/s 356/379/411/34 IPC PS: Okhla Industrial Area, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **08.10.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Akansha Gautam
JMFC-02, Room No. 513
Saket Courts Complex, New Delhi

DP/11733/SE/2026
(Court Matter)

State Urban Development Agency, Chhattisgarh

4th Floor, D Block, Indravati Bhavan (HOD Building), Nava Raipur Atal Nagar, Chhattisgarh, 492002

Phone 0771-2222401 Fax 0771/2222449 Email: csd.suda@yahoo.com

RFP Notice (2nd Call)

RFP Reference No.: PROJ-204/197/2026-SUDA (T M F F) SECTION / 403692-6

Nava Raipur Atal Nagar, Dated 18/08/2026

The State Urban Development Agency (SUDA), Chhattisgarh hereby invites proposals in conformity with the RFP document from registered and authorized agencies having experience and expertise in the similar field of work as per the criteria mentioned in the RFP document as below:

System Tender No.	Name of the Work	EMD	RFP Document Fee	Last date to download the RFP
197712	Request for Proposal (RFP) for Selection of an Agency for the Operation and Maintenance of 47 Aspirational Toilets under SBM 2.0 in Chhattisgarh (2nd Call)"	INR 5,00,000/-	INR 10,000/-	03.09.2026

The details regarding conditions stipulated in the RFP, EMD, Key dates for submission, detailed RFP, RFP document and all the information related to the RFP can be viewed and downloaded from e-procurement portal <https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in> or departmental website <https://suda.cg.gov.in>.

(Approved by Chief Executive Officer cum Mission Director (SBM-U 2.0))

SD/-

Dy. General Manager cum Superintendent Engineer
State Urban Development Agency,
Nava Raipur Atal Nagar

samvad 48824/1

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr.PC/84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Jaspreet Singh @ Rohit**, S/o Gurmeet Singh R/o D-57/2, Begum Vihar, Begumpur, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.308/22 dated 14.03.22 u/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Aman Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Jaspreet Singh @ Rohit** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Jaspreet Singh @ Rohit** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Jaspreet Singh @ Rohit** of **FIR No.308/22 dated 14.03.22 u/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Aman Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **24.09.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Shagun
Ld. Judicial Magistrate First Class-06
Room No.109, 1st Floor, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/11706/RD/2026



Yami Gautam Dhar to star in ‘Nayyi Navelli’

It promises to bring audiences together for a fun-filled theatrical experience

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, August 20

Amazon MGM Studios’ and ‘Colour Yellow’ announced India’s very own fantasy family-entertainment film, ‘Nayyi Navelli’, starring Yami Gautam Dhar, a perfect festive offering that promises to bring audiences together for a fun-filled theatrical experience.

Directed by Balaji Mohan and written by Himanshu Sharma and Divy Nidhi Sharma, this grand entertainer, with music by G V Prakash Kumar, takes audiences into a world where the extraordinary collides with family chaos, unleashing unexpected twists and plenty of laughs. ‘Nayyi Navelli’ is set to release in cinemas on October 16, 2026.

A picture-perfect bride transforms a chaotic Meerut household into paradise, only for her brother-in-law to suspect that his seemingly ideal sister-in-law may actually be a ‘daayan’ (witch)!

“As we saw ‘Nayyi Navelli’ finally come together, there was an instant, collective realisation that this is THE Dussehra film. No other date would do it justice,” said Nikhil Madhok, director and head of ‘SVOD Originals’, ‘Prime Video India’ and ‘Amazon MGM Studios’.



‘NAYYI NAVELLI IS THE KIND OF STORY THAT SURPRISES YOU AT EVERY TURN,’ SAYS PRODUCER AANAND L RAI

“Yami Gautam Dhar is brilliant and the talented ensemble cast has done a great job. This is our first collaboration with Aanand L Rai and Himanshu Sharma and they have created a remarkable movie. At ‘Amazon MGM Studios’, along with our partners at ‘Colour Yellow’, we are confident that ‘Nayyi Navelli’ will be the first choice of entertainment for family audiences this Dussehra.”

With comedy, chaos and a larger-than-life festive celebration, ‘Nayyi Navelli’ promises an entertaining big-screen experience.

Manoj to lead a new film on Mahatma Gandhi

Filmmakers Sudhir Mishra and Anubhav Sinha team up for the film

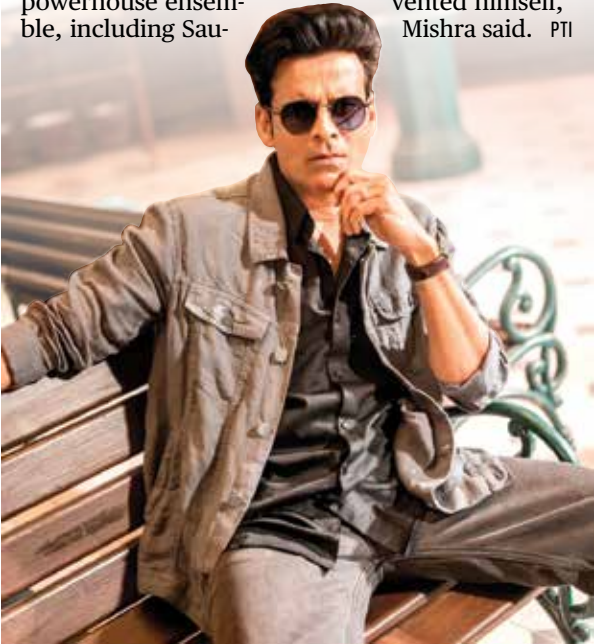
Filmmakers Sudhir Mishra and Anubhav Sinha have joined hands for a film about a lesser-known 21-day chapter of India’s independence history, with National Award-winner Manoj Bajpayee set to essay Mahatma Gandhi.

The new movie will be directed by Mishra, who is known for his political and social dramas such as ‘Hazaaroon Khwaishein Aisi’, ‘Dharavi’ and ‘Is Raat Ki Subah Nahin’. Sinha, who has directed films such as ‘Mulk’, ‘Article 15’ and ‘Thappad’, will produce the film via his banner ‘Benaras Media Works’.

The film also stars a powerhouse ensemble, including Sa-

THE FILM ALSO STARS A POWERHOUSE ENSEMBLE, INCLUDING SAURABH SHUKLA

rabh Shukla. “This new film focuses on an important yet lesser-known chapter of history: the 21 days in the life of Mahatma Gandhi during India’s independence. At a time when the nation was stepping into freedom and Delhi was becoming the centre of power, Gandhi made an unexpected choice: he chose to walk away. But by walking away, he did not retreat. He reinvented himself,” Mishra said. PTI



VIBE: Of survival instincts & friendship

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, August 20

One very unlikely gang, four completely different vibes and very few clues.

‘Amazon MGM Studios’ unveiled the teaser poster for its upcoming theatrical film ‘VIBE’, offering audiences another intriguing glimpse into Kunal Kemmu’s high-stakes action comedy while raising even more questions about the unlikely quartet caught in the middle of it all.

The brand-new poster features Preity G Zinta commanding attention in a striking boss-lady avatar. In stark contrast, Kunal Kemmu, Sparsh Shrivastava and Vanshika Dhir appear visibly distressed, hinting that whatever they’ve gotten themselves into has gone spectacularly off the rails.



‘VIBE’ centres on two inseparable friends whose ordinary, unassuming lives spiral into an unpredictable, high-energy adventure that pushes their survival instincts and friendship to the limit.

Written and directed by Kunal Kemmu, ‘VIBE’ is produced by Kunal Kemmu and Chirag Bhanu under the banner of ‘Drongo Films’ and stars Kemmu alongside Preity G Zinta, Sparsh Shrivastava and debutant Vanshika Dhir in lead roles.

‘ONLY MURDERS IN THE BUILDING’ S6

Olivia Colman joins the new season’s cast

Oscar winner Olivia Colman has joined the sixth season of mystery comedy series ‘Only Murders in the Building’, which is currently being filmed in the UK.

Colman’s casting was announced in a video shared on the show’s ‘Instagram’ account featuring returning stars Selena Gomez, Meryl Streep and Martin Short.

Gomez said the London-set season has welcomed several guest stars, before Streep points out that ‘we’re just missing one’, with Colman then appearing in the frame in costume.

Colman joins an increasingly star-studded



British ensemble for the upcoming season, which marks a major change in setting for the Hulu series as its amateur sleuths travel from New York to London.

The cast also includes David Tennant, Sharon Horgan, Martin Freeman, Jim Broadbent and many others. PTI

Tom Hanks in talks to headline film adaptation of ‘Theo of Golden’

‘Theo of Golden’ began as a self-published novel in 2023 by Allen Levi

Hollywood veteran Tom Hanks is in negotiations to lead the film adaptation of the best-selling novel ‘Theo of Golden’. ‘Warner Bros Pictures’ is negotiating the feature film rights to the book, penned by author Allen Levi.

The project is expected to be produced by Hanks along with Gil Netter and Gary Goetzman, while Levi will executive produce.

Set in the fictional town of Golden, the novel follows a mysterious man named Theo who arrives in the community and purchases pencil portraits of

THE PROJECT IS EXPECTED TO BE PRODUCED BY HANKS ALONG WITH GIL NETTER AND GARY GOETZMAN

local residents displayed at a coffee shop. Theo returns the portraits to their subjects and his encounters with the townspeople gradually reveal their stories, relationships and personal histories. His interactions with the community also force him to confront a tragedy from his own past.

‘Theo of Golden’ began as a self-published novel in 2023 by Levi, a first-time author who had previously pursued a career in law before turning to music. Simon & Schuster subsequently published the novel widely in October last year. PTI

